The Complete Catechism Kit

Your Catechism Year, Ready to Go

30 ready-to-teach weeks, September to June

Which activities to use, when, and in what order, in class or at home.



Pre-Catechesis · First Communion · Confirmation

For Parents and Catechists

The Complete Catechism Kit gives you more than 850 activities. This booklet tells you which ones to do, when, and in what order: 30 weeks for each stage, from September to June, following the 2026-2027 liturgical year as celebrated in the United States.

Each week fits on one page. Open it, print what it lists, and your class is ready.

Three Stages, One for Each Age Group

Pre-Catechesis	First Communion	Confirmation
Ages 4-6	Ages 7-9	Ages 10-12
pages 3-34	pages 35-66	pages 67-98

What You Will Find on Each Page

- **Your Year at a Glance**: two pages at the start of each stage listing the 30 weeks, their themes, and the kit pages to use.
- **In Class**: the lesson minute by minute, with the exact page of each kit activity.
- **At Home or If You Have Little Time**: the same week in 20 minutes, for parents or for a short class.
- **The Question of the Week and Something to Do at Home**: a question to ask your child or class and a simple activity to do as a family during the week.
- **To Print**: the pages to print before class, and how many copies.

A Few Tips

- The timing labels ("Early October," "Mid-November"...) are only a guide: adjust them to your parish calendar and school breaks. What matters is to keep the order of the weeks.
- The feast weeks (All Saints' Day, Advent, Christmas, the Epiphany, Ash Wednesday, Palm Sunday, Easter, the Ascension, Pentecost) stay on their calendar dates. If you start late, for example after Catechetical Sunday (September 20, 2026), or miss a class, shorten the other weeks rather than skipping a feast week. Otherwise, just pick up where you left off.
- Many parishes celebrate First Communion in late April or May, and the age for Confirmation varies by diocese. If your celebration comes before the end of the program, do the last weeks of preparation right before it.

In the year at a glance, the kit titles are abbreviated: Pre. = Pre-Catechesis · FC = First Communion · Conf. = Confirmation · +150 = 150 Extra Activities · Pr. = Catholic Prayers for Children · Stories = Illustrated Bible Stories · Games = Catechism Games. The number is the one printed at the bottom of each kit page.

Pre-Catechesis: Your Year at a Glance

Weeks 1-15, from late September to late January. Each week has its own page after these two.

Week	When	Theme	Kit Pages
1	Late September	**Welcome to Religious Ed: Jesus Loves Children**	+150 114, 117 · Pre. 118, 119, 120, 123, 125, 121, 122
2	Early October	**God Creates Light and the World**	Pre. 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10 · Pr. 1
3	October	**Thank You, God, for the World!**	Pre. 11, 14, 18, 19, 12, 13, 17 · Pr. 4
4	Mid-October	**My Guardian Angel Watches Over Me**	Pre. 162, 168, 165, 163, 167, 169 · Pr. 7
5	October	**Adam and Eve in God's Garden**	Pre. 21, 20, 23, 22, 26, 27, 25, 24 · Pr. 2
6	Late October	**Noah and the Ark**	Pre. 30, 28, 37, 39, 33, 31, 38 · Pr. 1
7	Early November	**All Saints' Day: The Great Family of Heaven**	+150 122, 127 · Pre. 191, 192
8	November	**Abraham, God's Friend**	Pre. 41, 40, 42, 43, 44, 47, 45, 46
9	Mid-November	**David, the Little Shepherd**	Pre. 61, 60, 62, 68, 66, 69, 64, 63, 65
10	Early December	**Advent: We Wait for Jesus**	Pre. 90, 88, 89 · +150 12, 18, 5, 15
11	December	**Mary Says Yes to God**	Pre. 81, 80, 83, 84, 82, 87, 86 · Pr. 3 · +150 130
12	Late December	**Christmas: Jesus Is Born!**	Pre. 91, 94, 102, 99, 100, 97 · Games 35 · +150 30
13	Early January	**The Epiphany: The Wise Men Follow the Star**	Pre. 109, 103, 104, 105, 106, 107 · +150 34
14	January	**The Holy Family in Nazareth**	Pre. 112, 110, 117, 115, 111, 113, 114 · Pr. 21
15	Late January	**The Church, God's House**	Pre. 185, 182, 197, 183, 184, 196, 194 · Pr. 4

+150 = 150 Extra Activities · Pre. = Pre-Catechesis · Pr. = Catholic Prayers for Children · Games = Catechism Games. Adjust the weeks to your parish calendar and school breaks.

Pre-Catechesis: Your Year at a Glance

Weeks 16-30, from early February to early June.

Week	When	Theme	Kit Pages
16	Early February	**I Make the Sign of the Cross**	Pre. 198, 199, 205, 200, 203, 204
17	February	**Lent Begins: Jonah and Nineveh**	Pre. 71, 72, 78, 73, 79, 74 · +150 44, 47 · Pr. 2
18	Late February	**Moses: God Guides His People**	Pre. 49, 53, 57, 54, 50, 59, 51, 55
19	Early March	**The Good Shepherd and the Lost Sheep**	Pre. 137, 136, 143, 138, 139, 140 · Games 26
20	March	**The Parables: The Tiny Seed**	Pre. 127, 126, 129, 130, 132, 128, 135 · Pr. 2
21	Mid-March	**Palm Sunday and Holy Week**	Pre. 144, 145, 148, 146, 147
22	Late March	**Easter: Jesus Is Alive!**	Pre. 150, 151, 157, 152, 153, 154, 156 · +150 84
23	April	**Alleluia, Jesus Is With Us**	Pre. 158, 149, 160, 159, 161, 155 · +150 79, 77
24	Mid-April	**Jesus Teaches Us to Pray**	Pre. 209, 206, 211, 212, 215, 207, 208, 210, 214 · Pr. 2
25	Late April	**Mary, the Mother of Jesus**	Pre. 174, 171, 180, 179, 181, 175 · Pr. 3 · +150 133
26	Early May	**The Ascension: Jesus Goes Up to Heaven**	+150 90 · Pre. 218, 213, 217, 219 · Pr. 4
27	Mid-May	**Pentecost: The Gift of the Holy Spirit**	+150 103, 95, 96 · Pre. 220, 221, 222, 223 · Pr. 12
28	May	**At Mass, Jesus Gathers Us**	Pre. 188, 186, 187, 189, 190, 193 · +150 105 · Pr. 1
29	Late May	**Acts of Love: I Share, I Say I'm Sorry**	Pre. 225, 230, 226, 224, 227, 232, 233
30	Early June	**Thank You, Lord, for This Year!**	Pre. 237, 235, 236, 231, 234 · Pr. 4

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Week 1

LATE SEPTEMBER

Welcome to Religious Ed: Jesus Loves Children

Goal: Help the children discover that Jesus welcomes every child and is happy when they come to him.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	Greet each child by name. The children color their notebook labels, and you write their names on them. → **"My Religious Ed Notebook Labels" (150 Extra Activities, p. 114)**
10 min	**Discover**	In your own words, tell how Jesus welcomes the children and keeps them close. The children color the picture. → **"Let the Children Come to Me" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 118)**
20 min	**Activity**	The children help the little girl reach Jesus, then trace each child's path to him. Early finishers: connect the dots to make the heart. → **"The Children Go to Jesus" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 119)** → **"The Path to Jesus" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 120)** → **"The Heart of Jesus" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 123)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Say the prayer for the new religious ed year line by line; the children repeat after you. → **"My Prayer for the New Religious Ed Year" (150 Extra Activities, p. 117)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color Jesus blessing the children together, count the children around him, and find the five differences.

→ **"Jesus Blesses the Children" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 125)**

→ **"Count the Children" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 121)**

→ **"Spot the Differences: Around Jesus" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 122)**

The Question of the Week

How does Jesus welcome the children who come to him?

Something to Do at Home

At bedtime, trace a small cross on your child's forehead to bless them.

To Print: "My Religious Ed Notebook Labels" (150 Extra Activities, p. 114): 1 per child · "Let the Children Come to Me" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 118): 1 per child · "The Children Go to Jesus" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 119): 1 per child · "The Path to Jesus" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 120): 1 per child · "The Heart of Jesus" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 123): 1 per child · "My Prayer for the New Religious Ed Year" (150 Extra Activities, p. 117): 1 for the adult

Week 2

EARLY OCTOBER

God Creates Light and the World

Goal: Help the children discover that God created the light, the sky, the sea, and all the beautiful things around us.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	Turn off the light for a moment, then turn it back on. Ask the children what changed.
10 min	**Discover**	Tell the beginning of the Creation story: God creates light. The children color the bright sky. → **"God Creates Light" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 4)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child colors the sun, the moon, and the stars, then traces the waves of the sea. Early finishers: connect the dots to make the fish. → **"The Sun, the Moon, and the Stars" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 5)** → **"The Waves of the Sea" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 6)** → **"The Fish in the Sea" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 7)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Make the Sign of the Cross together, then each child thanks God for one thing they love in the world. → **"The Sign of the Cross" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 1)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Count the stars, color the trees and flowers of the garden, then match each animal to its baby.

→ **"Count the Stars" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 8)**

→ **"The Trees and the Flowers" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 9)**

→ **"Each Animal and Its Baby" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 10)**

The Question of the Week

Of all the things God made, what do you like best?

Something to Do at Home

One evening, look at the sky through the window together and thank God for the moon and the stars.

To Print: "God Creates Light" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 4): 1 per child · "The Sun, the Moon, and the Stars" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 5): 1 per child · "The Waves of the Sea" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 6): 1 per child · "The Fish in the Sea" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 7): 1 per child

Week 3

OCTOBER

Thank You, God, for the World!

Goal: Help the children understand that the world is a gift from God and learn to say thank you to him.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children find the lion's shadow and circle it. → **"The Lion's Shadow" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 11)**
10 min	**Discover**	Go over the days of Creation. With your help, the children cut out the pictures and glue them onto their shadows, from day 1 to day 7. → **"The Seven Days of Creation" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 14)**
20 min	**Activity**	Make the Creation mobile together: the children color the circles, and you help them cut them out and hang them. → **"The Creation Mobile" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 18)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Glory Be together, raising your arms toward the sky. → **"The Glory Be" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 4)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week. Each child takes home the coloring page of the world to color. → **"Thank You, God, for the World!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 19)**

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Help the bird find its nest, spot the differences in the garden, and color the animals God created.

→ **"The Bird Finds Its Nest" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 12)**

→ **"Spot the Differences: In the Garden" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 13)**

→ **"God Creates the Animals" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 17)**

The Question of the Week

What do you want to thank God for today?

Something to Do at Home

On a walk, pick up a leaf or a pebble and thank God for the beauty of the world.

To Print: "The Lion's Shadow" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 11): 1 per child · "The Seven Days of Creation" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 14): 1 per child · "The Creation Mobile" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 18): 1 per child · "Thank You, God, for the World!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 19): 1 per child

Week 4

MID-OCTOBER

My Guardian Angel Watches Over Me

Goal: Help the children discover that God gives each of us a guardian angel who protects us.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	Ask the children who takes care of them when they are scared. Listen to each one.
10 min	**Discover**	Explain that God gives each of us a guardian angel. The children color the angel and the child. → **"My Guardian Angel" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 162)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child makes a paper angel glued onto a clothespin, to clip near their bed. Early finishers: guide the child to their angel. → **"My Paper Angel" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 168)** → **"My Angel Guides Me" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 165)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Teach the Guardian Angel Prayer line by line. → **"Guardian Angel Prayer" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 7)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Trace the angel's wings along the dotted lines, count the angels, and color the angel who watches over you at night.

→ **"My Angel's Wings" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 163)**
→ **"Count the Angels" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 167)**
→ **"My Angel Watches Over Me at Night" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 169)**

The Question of the Week

When would you like your guardian angel to be close to you?

Something to Do at Home

Every night before bed, pray the Guardian Angel Prayer together.

To Print: "My Guardian Angel" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 162): 1 per child · "My Paper Angel" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 168): 1 per child · "My Angel Guides Me" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 165): 1 per child

Week 5

OCTOBER

Adam and Eve in God's Garden

Goal: Help the children discover that God created man and woman and loves them with all his heart.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children trace the leaves of the garden along the dotted lines. → **"The Leaves of the Garden of Eden" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 21)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell how God gives Adam and Eve a beautiful garden. The children color the Garden of Eden. → **"Adam and Eve in the Garden" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 20)**
20 min	**Activity**	The children match each animal to its shadow, like Adam naming the animals, then count the fruit. Early finishers: guide the little lion to the big tree. → **"Adam Names the Animals" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 23)** → **"Count the Fruit on the Tree" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 22)** → **"The Lion Cub in the Garden of Eden" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 26)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Our Father; the children fold their hands and listen. → **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color Adam and Eve, whom God loves, connect the dots to make the fruit of the tree, and find the five differences in the garden.

→ **"God Loves Adam and Eve" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 27)**

→ **"The Fruit of the Tree" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 25)**

→ **"Spot the Differences: In the Garden of Eden" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 24)**

The Question of the Week

How do you know that God loves you?

Something to Do at Home

Every day this week, tell your child: "God loves you, and so do I."

To Print: "The Leaves of the Garden of Eden" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 21): 1 per child · "Adam and Eve in the Garden" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 20): 1 per child · "Adam Names the Animals" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 23): 1 per child · "Count the Fruit on the Tree" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 22): 1 per child · "The Lion Cub in the Garden of Eden" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 26): 1 per child

Week 6

LATE OCTOBER

Noah and the Ark

Goal: Help the children discover that Noah trusts God and that the rainbow is God's promise.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children trace the raindrops from the cloud down to the ground. → **"The Falling Rain" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 30)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell the story of Noah, who listens to God and builds the ark. The children color the ark, the animals, and the rainbow. → **"Noah and the Ark" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 28)**
20 min	**Activity**	With your help, the children cut out the animals and glue them onto their shadows to bring them aboard the ark. Then each child starts a paper rainbow. → **"The Animals Board the Ark" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 37)** → **"The Paper Rainbow" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 39)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Make the Sign of the Cross and thank God together for keeping his promises. → **"The Sign of the Cross" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 1)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Help the dove find the ark, match the animals two by two, and color God's rainbow promise.

→ **"The Dove Finds the Ark" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 33)**

→ **"The Animals Two by Two" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 31)**

→ **"God's Rainbow Promise" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 38)**

The Question of the Week

What does God promise with the rainbow?

Something to Do at Home

The next time it rains, look for a rainbow together and talk about God's promise.

To Print: "The Falling Rain" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 30): 1 per child · "Noah and the Ark" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 28): 1 per child · "The Animals Board the Ark" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 37): 1 per child · "The Paper Rainbow" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 39): 1 per child

Week 7

EARLY NOVEMBER

All Saints' Day: The Great Family of Heaven

All Saints' Day: Sunday, November 1, 2026 · All Souls' Day: November 2

Goal: Help the children discover that the saints are God's friends and that each of us has a saint who prays for us.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	Say each child's name and the saint who shares it (make the list ahead of time).
10 min	**Discover**	Explain that the saints are God's friends, with him in heaven. The children color the great family of heaven. → **"All the Saints in Heaven" (150 Extra Activities, p. 122)**
20 min	**Activity**	Fill in each child's patron saint page together: you write, and the child draws and colors. → **"My Patron Saint and Me" (150 Extra Activities, p. 127)**
5 min	**Prayer**	With your help, each child asks their patron saint to pray for them.
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Look at your child's Baptism photos, color the Baptism picture, and trace the water of Baptism along the dotted lines.

→ **"Baptism" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 191)**

→ **"The Water of Baptism" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 192)**

The Question of the Week

Who is your patron saint?

Something to Do at Home

On All Souls' Day, November 2, light a candle and pray as a family for your loved ones who have died.

To Print: "All the Saints in Heaven" (150 Extra Activities, p. 122): 1 per child · "My Patron Saint and Me" (150 Extra Activities, p. 127): 1 per child

Week 8

NOVEMBER

Abraham, God's Friend

Goal: Help the children discover that Abraham trusts God and that God keeps his promise.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children count Abraham's stars and color one box for each. → **"Count Abraham's Stars" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 41)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell how God promises Abraham a family as big as the stars in the sky. The children color the starry sky. → **"Abraham Looks at the Stars" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 40)**
20 min	**Activity**	The children trace Abraham's path to his tent, then help him get there with his camels. Early finishers: connect the dots to make the tent. → **"Abraham's Journey" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 42)** → **"Abraham Sets Out for the Promised Land" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 43)** → **"Abraham's Tent" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 44)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Say together three times, louder each time: "Lord, I trust in you."
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color Abraham's family with baby Isaac, match each sheep to its twin, and find the differences in the tent.

→ **"Isaac, the Promised Son" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 47)**

→ **"Abraham's Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 45)**

→ **"Spot the Differences: In the Tent" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 46)**

The Question of the Week

How does Abraham show that he trusts God?

Something to Do at Home

On a clear evening, count the stars together and remember God's promise to Abraham.

To Print: "Count Abraham's Stars" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 41): 1 per child · "Abraham Looks at the Stars" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 40): 1 per child · "Abraham's Journey" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 42): 1 per child · "Abraham Sets Out for the Promised Land" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 43): 1 per child · "Abraham's Tent" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 44): 1 per child

Week 9

MID-NOVEMBER

David, the Little Shepherd

Goal: Help the children discover that David is small but trusts God, and that Jesus will be born into his family.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children count David's sheep and color one box for each. → **"Count David's Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 61)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell the story of David, the young shepherd who takes care of his sheep and is not afraid of the giant. The children color David. → **"David, the Shepherd Boy" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 60)**
20 min	**Activity**	The children trace David's sling, then cut out the five stones with your help and glue them into the boxes. Early finishers: guide David back to his sheep. → **"David's Sling" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 62)** → **"David's Five Stones" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 68)** → **"David Returns to His Flock" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 66)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Show David singing to God with his harp, then sing together a song the children know. → **"David Plays the Harp" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 69)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color David facing Goliath, match the big pictures to the small ones, and connect the dots to make the shield.

→ **"David Faces Goliath" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 64)**

→ **"Big or Small?" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 63)**

→ **"Goliath's Shield" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 65)**

The Question of the Week

When you feel small, who can help you, the way God helped David?

Something to Do at Home

Sing a thank-you song to God as a family, like David with his harp, and sing it again at your Thanksgiving table.

To Print: "Count David's Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 61): 1 per child · "David, the Shepherd Boy" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 60): 1 per child · "David's Sling" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 62): 1 per child · "David's Five Stones" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 68): 1 per child · "David Returns to His Flock" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 66): 1 per child · "David Plays the Harp" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 69): 1 for the adult

Week 10

EARLY DECEMBER

Advent: We Wait for Jesus

First Sunday of Advent: November 29, 2026

Goal: Help the children understand that Advent is the time when we get our hearts ready to welcome Jesus at Christmas.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	If you have an Advent wreath, light the first candle. The children count the lit candles. → **"Count the Lit Candles" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 90)**
10 min	**Discover**	Explain that each Sunday of Advent, we light one more candle: three violet and one rose. The children match each part of the wreath to its color. → **"Match Each Candle to Its Color" (150 Extra Activities, p. 12)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child makes an Advent wreath: the children color it, and you help them cut it out and glue it onto a paper plate. → **"My Advent Wreath" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 88)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Read the first-week prayer from the little Advent prayer booklet; the children repeat after you. → **"My Little Advent Prayer Booklet" (150 Extra Activities, p. 18)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Each morning in December, color one box of the Advent calendar. Also color the wreath and start the good-deed paper chain.

→ **"The Advent Coloring Calendar, One Box a Day" (150 Extra Activities, p. 5)**

→ **"The Four Advent Candles" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 89)**

→ **"The Advent Good Deeds Paper Chain" (150 Extra Activities, p. 15)**

The Question of the Week

What kind thing can you do this week to get your heart ready for Christmas?

Something to Do at Home

Each Sunday of Advent, light one more candle as a family.

To Print: "Count the Lit Candles" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 90): 1 per child · "Match Each Candle to Its Color" (150 Extra Activities, p. 12): 1 per child · "My Advent Wreath" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 88): 1 per child · "My Little Advent Prayer Booklet" (150 Extra Activities, p. 18): 1 for the adult · "The Advent Coloring Calendar, One Box a Day" (150 Extra Activities, p. 5): 1 per child · "The Advent Good Deeds Paper Chain" (150 Extra Activities, p. 15): 1 per child

Week 11

DECEMBER

Mary Says Yes to God

The Immaculate Conception: Tuesday, December 8, 2026 (holy day of obligation)

Goal: Help the children discover that the angel Gabriel tells Mary she will be the mother of Jesus, and that Mary says yes.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children trace the feathers of the angel's wings along the dotted lines. → **"The Angel's Wings" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 81)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell about the angel Gabriel's visit to Mary. The children color the scene. → **"The Angel Gabriel Visits Mary" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 80)**
20 min	**Activity**	The children help the angel reach Mary's house, then match each lily to its shadow. Early finishers: connect the dots to make the angel Gabriel. → **"The Angel Goes to Mary" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 83)** → **"Mary's Lilies" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 84)** → **"The Angel Gabriel" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 82)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Hail Mary slowly; the children repeat each line. → **"The Hail Mary" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 3)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color Mary saying yes to God, then Our Lady of the Immaculate Conception, and count the lilies.

→ **"Mary Says Yes to God" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 87)**

→ **"The Immaculate Conception (December 8)" (150 Extra Activities, p. 130)**

→ **"Count the Lilies" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 86)**

The Question of the Week

What does Mary answer the angel?

Something to Do at Home

On December 8, the feast of the Immaculate Conception, go to Mass as a family and pray a Hail Mary together.

To Print: "The Angel's Wings" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 81): 1 per child · "The Angel Gabriel Visits Mary" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 80): 1 per child · "The Angel Goes to Mary" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 83): 1 per child · "Mary's Lilies" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 84): 1 per child · "The Angel Gabriel" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 82): 1 per child

Week 12

LATE DECEMBER

Christmas: Jesus Is Born!

Christmas: Friday, December 25, 2026

Goal: Help the children discover that Jesus, the Son of God, is born in Bethlehem and comes for all of us.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children trace the donkey's path to the stable in Bethlehem. → **"The Road to Bethlehem" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 91)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell about Mary and Joseph's journey, the inn with no room, and the birth of Jesus. The children color Jesus, Mary, and Joseph. → **"Jesus Is Born!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 94)**
20 min	**Activity**	With your help, the children cut out the figures and glue them onto their shadows to make their Nativity scene. Early finishers: the Nativity puzzle. → **"I Make My Nativity Scene" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 102)** → **"Nativity Puzzle" (Catechism Games, p. 35)**
5 min	**Prayer**	In front of the Nativity scene, softly read the Christmas prayer; the children repeat after you. → **"My Prayer at the Nativity Scene" (150 Extra Activities, p. 30)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color the shepherds and the angels, help the little shepherd go see Jesus, and find the differences at the manger.

→ **"The Shepherds and the Angels" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 99)**

→ **"The Shepherd Goes to the Manger" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 100)**

→ **"Spot the Differences: At the Manger" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 97)**

The Question of the Week

What gift can you give Jesus for Christmas?

Something to Do at Home

On Christmas Eve, place Baby Jesus in your Nativity scene at home together.

To Print: "The Road to Bethlehem" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 91): 1 per child · "Jesus Is Born!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 94): 1 per child · "I Make My Nativity Scene" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 102): 1 per child · "Nativity Puzzle" (Catechism Games, p. 35): 1 per child · "My Prayer at the Nativity Scene" (150 Extra Activities, p. 30): 1 for the adult

Week 13

EARLY JANUARY

The Epiphany: The Wise Men Follow the Star

The Epiphany: Sunday, January 3, 2027

Goal: Help the children discover that the Wise Men come from far away to worship Jesus: he came for all peoples.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children color Jesus in the manger and wish him a merry Christmas. → **"Merry Christmas, Jesus!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 109)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell about the journey of the Wise Men, who follow the star all the way to Jesus. The children color the Wise Men and their camels. → **"The Wise Men and the Star" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 103)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child decorates a Wise Men's crown; you help cut it out and fit it to their head. Early finishers: guide the camel to the star. → **"The Wise Men's Crown to Decorate" (150 Extra Activities, p. 34)** → **"The Wise Men Follow the Star" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 104)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Wearing their crowns, the children bow before the Nativity scene and whisper: "Jesus, I love you."
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Match each gift of the Wise Men to its shadow, draw what comes next in the pattern of stars, and make the hanging star.

→ **"The Gifts of the Wise Men" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 105)**

→ **"Star Pattern" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 106)**

→ **"My Hanging Christmas Star" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 107)**

The Question of the Week

What gifts do the Wise Men bring to Jesus?

Something to Do at Home

Do the Epiphany chalk blessing: write 20 + C + M + B + 27 above your front door and tell the story of the Wise Men.

To Print: "Merry Christmas, Jesus!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 109): 1 per child · "The Wise Men and the Star" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 103): 1 per child · "The Wise Men's Crown to Decorate" (150 Extra Activities, p. 34): 1 per child · "The Wise Men Follow the Star" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 104): 1 per child

Week 14

JANUARY

The Holy Family in Nazareth

The Baptism of the Lord: Sunday, January 10, 2027

Goal: Help the children discover that Jesus grows up in a family with Mary and Joseph, just as we do in ours.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children trace over the dotted lines to draw Joseph's tools. → **"Joseph's Tools" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 112)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell about Jesus' life in Nazareth with Mary and Joseph. The children color the Holy Family. → **"Jesus, Mary, and Joseph" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 110)**
20 min	**Activity**	With your help, the children cut out the pictures of the house in Nazareth and glue them onto their shadows. Early finishers: help Joseph find Jesus in the Temple. → **"The House in Nazareth" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 117)** → **"Mary and Joseph Find Jesus in the Temple" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 115)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Prayer to the Holy Family; each child names someone in their family. → **"Prayer to the Holy Family" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 21)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color Jesus helping Joseph in the workshop, match each tool to its shadow, and count the boards.

→ **"Joseph the Carpenter" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 111)**

→ **"The Shadows of Joseph's Tools" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 113)**

→ **"Count the Boards" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 114)**

The Question of the Week

How can you help your family, the way Jesus helped Joseph?

Something to Do at Home

Give your child a small job at home for the whole week, like Jesus in the workshop.

To Print: "Joseph's Tools" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 112): 1 per child · "Jesus, Mary, and Joseph" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 110): 1 per child · "The House in Nazareth" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 117): 1 per child · "Mary and Joseph Find Jesus in the Temple" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 115): 1 per child

Week 15

LATE JANUARY

The Church, God's House

Goal: Help the children discover that the church is God's house, where the big family of Christians gathers to pray.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children help the child find the way to church. → **"I Go to Church" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 185)**
10 min	**Discover**	Show a photo of your parish church, or visit it if you can. The children color the church. → **"My Church" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 182)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child colors a paper stained-glass window; you rub it with a little oil to make it glow. Early finishers: connect the dots to make the steeple. → **"My Paper Stained-Glass Window" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 197)** → **"The Church Steeple" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 183)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Imitate the sound of church bells together, then pray the Glory Be. → **"The Glory Be" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 4)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Trace the sound of the bells, color the big family of the Church, and cut out the church objects and glue them in their places.

→ **"The Bells Are Ringing" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 184)**

→ **"The Big Family of the Church" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 196)**

→ **"I Tidy Up the Church" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 194)**

The Question of the Week

What do you like to look at in church?

Something to Do at Home

On Sunday, get to Mass a little early and walk around the church with your child.

To Print: "I Go to Church" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 185): 1 per child · "My Church" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 182): 1 per child · "My Paper Stained-Glass Window" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 197): 1 per child · "The Church Steeple" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 183): 1 per child

Week 16

EARLY FEBRUARY

I Make the Sign of the Cross

Goal: Help the children learn to make the Sign of the Cross, the gesture we use to begin our prayers.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	Slowly make the Sign of the Cross in front of the children, then all make it together.
10 min	**Discover**	The children color the child making the Sign of the Cross, then trace over the dotted lines of the cross. → **"I Make the Sign of the Cross" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 198)** → **"I Trace the Cross" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 199)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child decorates a cross with glitter or stickers for their prayer corner; you help them cut it out. Early finishers: connect the dots to make the cross. → **"My Decorated Cross" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 205)** → **"The Cross" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 200)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Each child makes the Sign of the Cross and thanks Jesus for one thing from their day.
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Help the little girl find the way to the cross, count the crosses, and make the Sign of the Cross together.

→ **"Find the Way to the Cross" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 203)**

→ **"Count the Crosses" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 204)**

The Question of the Week

Where do you start when you make the Sign of the Cross?

Something to Do at Home

Make the Sign of the Cross together before every meal this week.

To Print: "I Make the Sign of the Cross" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 198): 1 per child · "I Trace the Cross" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 199): 1 per child · "My Decorated Cross" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 205): 1 per child · "The Cross" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 200): 1 per child

Week 17

FEBRUARY

Lent Begins: Jonah and Nineveh

Ash Wednesday: February 10, 2027

Goal: Help the children understand that Lent is a time to come back to God, like the city of Nineveh.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children trace the big waves of the storm. → **"The Waves of the Storm" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 71)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell the story of Jonah: the storm, the big fish, then Nineveh coming back to God. The children color Jonah inside the fish. → **"Jonah in the Big Fish" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 72)**
20 min	**Activity**	With your help, the children cut out the pictures of Jonah's story and glue them onto their shadows. Early finishers: connect the dots to make the big fish. → **"Jonah and the Big Fish" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 78)** → **"The Big Fish" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 73)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Show the Lenten path, then pray the Our Father together. → **"The Lenten Path: 40 Steps to Easter" (150 Extra Activities, p. 44)** → **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color the city of Nineveh, help the big fish swim to the shore, and color Jesus praying in the desert.

→ **"Jonah in Nineveh" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 79)**

→ **"The Fish Swims to the Shore" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 74)**

→ **"Jesus Prays for Forty Days in the Desert" (150 Extra Activities, p. 47)**

The Question of the Week

What can you do during Lent to grow closer to God?

Something to Do at Home

Hang up the Lenten path and color one step each evening that someone gave something up or made an extra effort.

To Print: "The Waves of the Storm" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 71): 1 per child · "Jonah in the Big Fish" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 72): 1 per child · "Jonah and the Big Fish" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 78): 1 per child · "The Big Fish" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 73): 1 per child · "The Lenten Path: 40 Steps to Easter" (150 Extra Activities, p. 44): 1 per child

Week 18

LATE FEBRUARY

Moses: God Guides His People

Goal: Help the children discover that God takes care of his people and guides them, just as he guides us during Lent.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children help baby Moses' basket float down the river. → **"The Basket on the River" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 49)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell the story of Moses: the burning bush, the sea that opens, and the desert. The children color the open sea. → **"The Sea Opens" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 53)**
20 min	**Activity**	With your help, the children cut out the pictures of Moses' story and glue them onto their shadows. Early finishers: help the child cross the sea. → **"The Ten Commandments" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 57)** → **"Cross the Sea With the People" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 54)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Show the burning bush: God speaks to Moses. Keep a moment of silence to listen to God, then say Amen together. → **"The Burning Bush" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 50)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color Moses on the mountain, trace the flames of the bush, and count the quail God gives his people.

→ **"Moses on the Mountain" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 59)**
→ **"The Flames of the Bush" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 51)**
→ **"Count the Quail" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 55)**

The Question of the Week

How does God take care of you?

Something to Do at Home

Each time someone gives up a treat, put a coin in your Lenten rice bowl or a jar, to give to the poor at Easter.

To Print: "The Basket on the River" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 49): 1 per child · "The Sea Opens" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 53): 1 per child · "The Ten Commandments" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 57): 1 per child · "Cross the Sea With the People" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 54): 1 per child · "The Burning Bush" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 50): 1 for the adult

Week 19

EARLY MARCH

The Good Shepherd and the Lost Sheep

Goal: Help the children discover that Jesus is the Good Shepherd: he looks for each of us and rejoices when we come back to him.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children count the Good Shepherd's sheep. → **"Count the Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 137)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell the story of the lost sheep and the shepherd who looks for it everywhere. The children color the Good Shepherd and his sheep. → **"The Good Shepherd and His Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 136)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child makes a cotton ball sheep. Early finishers: guide the little sheep to Jesus, first with a finger, then with a pencil. → **"My Cotton Ball Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 143)** → **"The Lost Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 138)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Say together: "Jesus, Good Shepherd, thank you for always looking for me."
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Trace the path of the sheep to the shepherd, find the sheep's shadow, and do the Good Shepherd maze.

→ **"The Shepherd's Path" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 139)**

→ **"The Shadow of the Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 140)**

→ **"The Good Shepherd Looks for His Sheep" (Catechism Games, p. 26)**

The Question of the Week

What does the shepherd do when he finds his sheep?

Something to Do at Home

After an argument, make peace as a family with a hug, like the shepherd who finds his sheep.

To Print: "Count the Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 137): 1 per child · "The Good Shepherd and His Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 136): 1 per child · "My Cotton Ball Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 143): 1 per child · "The Lost Sheep" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 138): 1 per child

Week 20

MARCH

The Parables: The Tiny Seed

Goal: Help the children discover that Jesus tells stories to talk about God, whose love grows in us like a seed.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children trace the furrows in the field along the dotted lines. → **"The Seeds in the Furrows" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 127)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell the parable of the sower, then the one about the tiny seed that becomes a big tree. The children color the sower. → **"The Sower and the Seeds" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 126)**
20 min	**Activity**	With your help, the children cut out the pictures and glue them in order: the sprout, the flower, the tree, the fruit. Then they color the house built on rock. → **"The Seed Becomes a Plant" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 129)** → **"The House on the Rock" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 130)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Our Father together with folded hands. → **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color the big mustard tree, count the little sprouts, and help the woman find her coin.

→ **"The Tiny Mustard Seed" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 132)**

→ **"Count the Sprouts" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 128)**

→ **"The Woman Finds Her Coin" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 135)**

The Question of the Week

What makes God's love grow in your heart?

Something to Do at Home

Plant a seed in a pot and water it every day with your child until Easter.

To Print: "The Seeds in the Furrows" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 127): 1 per child · "The Sower and the Seeds" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 126): 1 per child · "The Seed Becomes a Plant" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 129): 1 per child · "The House on the Rock" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 130): 1 per child

Week 21

MID-MARCH

Palm Sunday and Holy Week

Palm Sunday: March 21, 2027

Goal: Help the children discover that the crowd welcomes Jesus into Jerusalem and that, during Holy Week, Jesus gives his life out of love.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	Wave a branch and shout "Hosanna!" together, like the crowd.
10 min	**Discover**	Tell how Jesus enters Jerusalem riding a little donkey. The children color the scene. → **"Jesus Enters Jerusalem" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 144)**
15 min	**Activity**	Each child makes a palm to wave at Mass on Sunday. → **"My Palm for Palm Sunday" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 145)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Tell simply about Jesus' Last Supper, then how he gave his life for us, out of love. The children trace the cross; then everyone prays for a moment in silence before a crucifix. → **"The Cross of Jesus" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 148)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color Jesus at the Last Supper with his friends, then count the loaves and the cups.

→ **"The Last Supper" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 146)**

→ **"Count the Loaves and the Cups" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 147)**

The Question of the Week

What does the crowd do when Jesus arrives in Jerusalem?

Something to Do at Home

Go to Palm Sunday Mass with the palm your child made, then hang it near the crucifix at home.

To Print: "Jesus Enters Jerusalem" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 144): 1 per child · "My Palm for Palm Sunday" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 145): 1 per child · "The Cross of Jesus" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 148): 1 per child

Week 22

LATE MARCH

Easter: Jesus Is Alive!

Easter Sunday: March 28, 2027

Goal: Help the children share the great joy of Easter: Jesus is risen, and he is alive forever.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children follow the women's path to the tomb. → **"The Women Go to the Tomb" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 150)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell about Easter morning: the stone rolled away, the empty tomb, Jesus alive. The children color the empty tomb. → **"The Tomb Is Empty!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 151)**
20 min	**Activity**	With your help, the children cut out the pictures and glue them onto their shadows to tell the Easter story. Early finishers: connect the dots to make the stone rolled away. → **"The Easter Story in Pictures" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 157)** → **"The Stone Rolled Away" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 152)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Read the Easter morning prayer; at the end, everyone raises their arms and says "Alleluia!" → **"My Easter Morning Prayer" (150 Extra Activities, p. 84)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color the risen Jesus in the light, find the differences on Easter morning, and find the shadow of the Easter candle.

→ **"Jesus Is Risen!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 153)**

→ **"Spot the Differences: Easter Morning" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 154)**

→ **"The Easter Candle (the Paschal Candle)" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 156)**

The Question of the Week

Why are Jesus' friends so happy on Easter morning?

Something to Do at Home

All through Easter week, say "Alleluia!" as a family before meals.

To Print: "The Women Go to the Tomb" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 150): 1 per child · "The Tomb Is Empty!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 151): 1 per child · "The Easter Story in Pictures" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 157): 1 per child · "The Stone Rolled Away" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 152): 1 per child · "My Easter Morning Prayer" (150 Extra Activities, p. 84): 1 for the adult

Week 23

APRIL

Alleluia, Jesus Is With Us

Goal: Help the children discover that the risen Jesus meets his friends again and shares bread with them: the joy of Easter goes on.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	In the green box, the children draw the egg that comes next. → **"Easter Egg Pattern" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 158)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell how Jesus, alive, shares bread with two friends. The children color the picture. → **"Jesus Is Alive!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 149)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child makes a paper cross with stickers. Early finishers: cross out the one that doesn't belong at Easter. → **"My Paper Cross" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 160)** → **"Odd One Out at Easter" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 159)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Show Jesus' joyful friends and sing "Alleluia" together. → **"Alleluia, Jesus Is Alive!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 161)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Decorate the Easter eggs for your table, color Jesus calling Mary Magdalene, and match the Easter flowers to their shadows.

→ **"Easter Eggs to Decorate" (150 Extra Activities, p. 79)**
→ **"The Risen Jesus Appears to Mary Magdalene" (150 Extra Activities, p. 77)**
→ **"Easter Flowers" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 155)**

The Question of the Week

How can you show your joy that Jesus is alive?

Something to Do at Home

Put the paper cross in your prayer corner and light a candle there for evening prayer.

To Print: "Easter Egg Pattern" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 158): 1 per child · "Jesus Is Alive!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 149): 1 per child · "My Paper Cross" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 160): 1 per child · "Odd One Out at Easter" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 159): 1 per child · "Alleluia, Jesus Is Alive!" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 161): 1 for the adult

Week 24

MID-APRIL

Jesus Teaches Us to Pray

Goal: Help the children discover that praying means talking to Jesus, in the morning, at bedtime, and at any time.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children trace over the dotted lines to draw the folded hands. → **"My Folded Hands" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 209)**
10 min	**Discover**	Show how we fold our hands to talk to Jesus. The children color the picture. → **"I Pray With My Hands Folded" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 206)**
20 min	**Activity**	The children color the morning prayer and the bedtime prayer, then match each picture to the sun or the moon. → **"Morning Prayer" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 211)** → **"Bedtime Prayer" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 212)** → **"Morning or Night?" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 215)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Show the Our Father picture, then pray it together with folded hands. → **"The Our Father" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 207)** → **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color Mary with the Hail Mary, help the child join the family prayer, and connect the dots to make the candle.

→ **"The Hail Mary" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 208)**

→ **"I Join My Family for Prayer" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 210)**

→ **"The Prayer Candle" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 214)**

The Question of the Week

What time of day do you like to talk to Jesus?

Something to Do at Home

Choose a set time for a short family prayer, in the morning or at bedtime.

To Print: "My Folded Hands" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 209): 1 per child · "I Pray With My Hands Folded" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 206): 1 per child · "Morning Prayer" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 211): 1 per child · "Bedtime Prayer" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 212): 1 per child · "Morning or Night?" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 215): 1 per child · "The Our Father" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 207): 1 for the adult

Week 25

LATE APRIL

Mary, the Mother of Jesus

Goal: Help the children discover that Mary is the mother of Jesus and that we can talk to her in prayer.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children follow the path to bring the rose to Mary. → **"I Bring a Rose to Mary" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 174)**
10 min	**Discover**	Explain that May is Mary's month, when many parishes crown her statue with flowers. The children color Mary holding the Child Jesus. → **"Mary and the Child Jesus" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 171)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child makes one decade of a rosary with paper beads; you help cut out and string the beads. Early finishers: cut out and glue the bouquet for Mary. → **"My Paper Bead Rosary" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 180)** → **"A Bouquet for Mary" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 179)**
5 min	**Prayer**	With the rosary they made, pray a Hail Mary together. → **"The Hail Mary" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 3)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Set up a corner for Mary in your child's room, color Mary, Queen of Heaven, and count the roses.

→ **"A Prayer Corner for Mary in May" (150 Extra Activities, p. 133)**

→ **"Mary, Queen of Heaven" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 181)**

→ **"Count the Roses" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 175)**

The Question of the Week

What would you like to say to Mary?

Something to Do at Home

During May, put a flower in Mary's corner and say good night to her before bed.

To Print: "I Bring a Rose to Mary" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 174): 1 per child · "Mary and the Child Jesus" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 171): 1 per child · "My Paper Bead Rosary" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 180): 1 per child · "A Bouquet for Mary" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 179): 1 per child · "A Prayer Corner for Mary in May" (150 Extra Activities, p. 133): 1 per child

Week 26

EARLY MAY

The Ascension: Jesus Goes Up to Heaven

The Ascension: Thursday, May 6 or Sunday, May 9, 2027 (depending on your diocese)

Goal: Help the children discover that Jesus goes up to heaven to be with his Father and that he stays with us when we pray.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	Look at the sky through the window together and ask the children what they see.
10 min	**Discover**	Tell how Jesus goes up to heaven in front of his friends and promises to stay with them. The children color the scene. → **"Jesus Ascends Into Heaven" (150 Extra Activities, p. 90)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child makes a prayer box; you help cut it out and fold it. The children put a first drawing for Jesus inside. → **"My Prayer Box" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 218)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Glory Be together, raising your arms toward the sky. → **"The Glory Be" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 4)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color the family saying thank you before the meal, cut out the prayer corner objects, and color the prayer for the people you love.

→ **"Grace Before Meals" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 213)**

→ **"My Prayer Corner" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 217)**

→ **"I Pray for the People I Love" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 219)**

The Question of the Week

Where is Jesus now, and how can you talk to him?

Something to Do at Home

Say grace together before every meal this week.

To Print: "Jesus Ascends Into Heaven" (150 Extra Activities, p. 90): 1 per child · "My Prayer Box" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 218): 1 per child

Week 27

MID-MAY

Pentecost: The Gift of the Holy Spirit

Pentecost: Sunday, May 16, 2027

Goal: Help the children discover that Jesus sends the Holy Spirit, who helps us love the way Jesus loves.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children trace the path to the flame and color it. → **"Follow the Flames of Pentecost" (150 Extra Activities, p. 103)**
10 min	**Discover**	Tell the story of Pentecost: the strong wind, the flames, the joy of the Apostles. The children color the scene. → **"The Holy Spirit Comes Down on the Apostles" (150 Extra Activities, p. 95)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child colors the dove and cuts it out with your help, to hang it up. Then the children color the two friends sharing their snack. → **"The Pentecost Dove to Hang" (150 Extra Activities, p. 96)** → **"I Share My Snack" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 220)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray "Come, Holy Spirit" together; the children repeat after you. → **"Come, Holy Spirit" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 12)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color the child helping to set the table and the one comforting a friend, then trace the hearts for the people you love.

→ **"I Help at Home" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 221)**

→ **"I Comfort My Friend" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 222)**

→ **"Hearts for the People I Love" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 223)**

The Question of the Week

How can the Holy Spirit help you be kind this week?

Something to Do at Home

Hang the dove near a window and, each morning, ask the Holy Spirit together to help you love.

To Print: "Follow the Flames of Pentecost" (150 Extra Activities, p. 103): 1 per child · "The Holy Spirit Comes Down on the Apostles" (150 Extra Activities, p. 95): 1 per child · "The Pentecost Dove to Hang" (150 Extra Activities, p. 96): 1 per child · "I Share My Snack" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 220): 1 per child

Week 28

MAY

At Mass, Jesus Gathers Us

Goal: Help the children discover that at Mass God's family gathers around Jesus, and that the priest shows us the host.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children find the chalice's shadow and circle it. → **"The Shadow of the Chalice" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 188)**
10 min	**Discover**	Explain the Mass simply: we listen to Jesus, we pray together, and the priest shows the host. The children color the priest at the altar. → **"The Priest at the Altar" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 186)**
20 min	**Activity**	The children match each object used at Mass to its shadow, then color and cut out the petals for the Corpus Christi procession. → **"The Objects Used at Mass" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 187)** → **"Petals for the Procession" (150 Extra Activities, p. 105)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Make the Sign of the Cross together, as we do at the start of Mass. → **"The Sign of the Cross" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 1)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Count the altar candles, find the differences in the church, and cross out the one that doesn't belong.

→ **"Count the Altar Candles" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 189)**

→ **"Spot the Differences: In the Church" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 190)**

→ **"Odd One Out in the Church" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 193)**

The Question of the Week

What do you see the priest do at Mass?

Something to Do at Home

At Sunday Mass, show your child the altar, the chalice, and the candles.

To Print: "The Shadow of the Chalice" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 188): 1 per child · "The Priest at the Altar" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 186): 1 per child · "The Objects Used at Mass" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 187): 1 per child · "Petals for the Procession" (150 Extra Activities, p. 105): 1 per child

Week 29

LATE MAY

Acts of Love: I Share, I Say I'm Sorry

Goal: Help the children discover that Jesus teaches us to love through simple acts: sharing, helping, saying sorry.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	The children count the hearts and color one box for each. → **"Count the Hearts" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 225)**
10 min	**Discover**	Show the two children making peace: saying sorry is an act of love. The children color the picture. → **"I Say I'm Sorry" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 230)**
20 min	**Activity**	With your help, the children cut out the pictures of kind deeds and glue them into the big heart. Early finishers: connect the dots to make the big heart. → **"Kind Deeds" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 226)** → **"The Big Heart" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 224)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Each child says the name of someone they love, then you pray for them together.
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Help the child bring a flower to Mom, match each picture to its twin, and draw what comes next in the pattern of hearts.

→ **"I Bring Mom a Flower" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 227)**

→ **"Who Needs Help?" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 232)**

→ **"Heart Pattern" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 233)**

The Question of the Week

What act of love did you do today?

Something to Do at Home

At bedtime, each of you tells about one act of love you gave or received that day.

To Print: "Count the Hearts" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 225): 1 per child · "I Say I'm Sorry" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 230): 1 per child · "Kind Deeds" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 226): 1 per child · "The Big Heart" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 224): 1 per child

Week 30

EARLY JUNE

Thank You, Lord, for This Year!

Goal: Help the children thank God for everything they learned and shared in religious ed this year and for the people they love.

In Class 45 min

5 min	**Welcome**	Go over the stories of the year together: Creation, Noah, Christmas, Easter... Each child says which one they like best.
10 min	**Discover**	Show the picture: Jesus teaches us to love one another. The children color it. → **"Jesus Teaches Us to Love" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 237)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child makes a thank-you heart for someone they love. Then each child cuts out their friendship chain, and you hang it up together. → **"My Thank-You Heart" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 235)** → **"My Friendship Chain" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 236)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Glory Be together, then each child thanks God for one moment of the year. → **"The Glory Be" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 4)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and trace a small cross on each child's forehead to bless them.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color the child saying thank you to Grandma, cross out the one that doesn't belong among the acts of love, and give the thank-you heart.

→ **"I Say Thank You" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 231)**

→ **"Odd One Out: Acts of Love" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 234)**

The Question of the Week

What did you like best in religious ed this year?

Something to Do at Home

Over the summer, keep your prayer corner at home and thank God each night for one good moment.

To Print: "Jesus Teaches Us to Love" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 237): 1 per child · "My Thank-You Heart" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 235): 1 per child · "My Friendship Chain" (Pre-Catechesis, p. 236): 1 per child

First Communion: Your Year at a Glance

Weeks 1-15, from late September to late January. Each week has its own page after these two.

Week	When	Theme	Kit Pages
1	Late September	**Welcome to Religious Ed!**	+150 115, 119, 121 · FC 72 · Pr. 1
2	Early October	**God Creates the World**	Stories 4, 5 · FC 5, 6 · Pr. 4
3	October	**Adam, Eve, and Noah: God Makes a Covenant**	FC 7, 8, 9 · Pr. 10 · Stories 8
4	Mid-October	**Abraham and Moses: God Guides His People**	FC 10, 11, 12 · Pr. 8 · Stories 10, 16
5	October	**The Ten Commandments**	FC 175, 177, 179, 176, 192 · Pr. 20
6	Late October	**Love God and Your Neighbor**	FC 185, 187, 188, 29 · Pr. 9
7	Early November	**All Saints' Day: All Called to Be Saints**	+150 122, 125, 127, 128, 129 · Pr. 5
8	November	**Jesus Teaches Us to Pray**	FC 70, 73, 75, 74, 92 · Pr. 2
9	Mid-November	**Mary, Our Mother**	FC 77, 95, 79, 78, 96 · Pr. 3
10	Early December	**Advent: We Get Our Hearts Ready**	+150 7, 9, 5 · FC 198, 199 · Pr. 19
11	December	**The Annunciation: Mary Says Yes**	Stories 24, 25 · FC 16 · +150 11, 130 · Pr. 15
12	Late December	**Christmas: Jesus Comes Among Us**	FC 17, 120, 18 · +150 19, 20, 21, 30
13	Early January	**The Epiphany: The Wise Men Follow the Star**	+150 36, 37, 38 · FC 19 · Pr. 18
14	January	**The Baptism of Jesus and My Baptism**	Stories 30 · FC 21, 42, 43, 50, 47, 45 · Pr. 1
15	Late January	**The Seven Sacraments**	FC 35, 37, 38, 36, 39 · Pr. 4 · Games 22

+150 = 150 Extra Activities · FC = First Communion · Pr. = Catholic Prayers for Children · Stories = Illustrated Bible Stories · Games = Catechism Games. Adjust the weeks to your parish calendar and school breaks. Many parishes celebrate First Communion in late April or May: if yours comes before June, do weeks 28 and 29 right before it.

First Communion: Your Year at a Glance

Weeks 16-30, from early February to early June.

Week	When	Theme	Kit Pages
16	Early February	**The Miracles of Jesus**	Stories 32, 36 · FC 22, 25, 26, 27 · Pr. 18
17	February	**Lent: Pray, Fast, Give**	+150 46, 48, 44, 50 · FC 201, 202 · Pr. 6
18	Late February	**God Always Forgives**	FC 30, 57, 55, 31, 59 · Pr. 6
19	Early March	**The Sacrament of Reconciliation**	FC 52, 53, 56, 54, 58 · Pr. 6
20	March	**My Examination of Conscience**	FC 213, 214, 215, 222, 216, 219 · Pr. 9
21	Mid-March	**Palm Sunday and Holy Week**	FC 33, 163, 165 · +150 72, 61, 68 · Pr. 2
22	Late March	**Easter: Jesus Is Alive!**	FC 34 · +150 77, 85, 81, 84 · Pr. 4
23	April	**The Eucharist: Jesus Really Present**	FC 203, 60, 61, 64, 63, 65 · Pr. 18
24	Mid-April	**The Mass, Part 1: We Listen to God's Word**	FC 115, 116, 121, 122, 142 · Pr. 5
25	Late April	**The Mass, Part 2: The Bread and the Wine**	FC 125, 130, 128, 138, 144 · Pr. 2
26	Early May	**The Ascension: Jesus Stays With Us**	+150 94, 92 · FC 145, 160, 150, 148 · Pr. 14
27	Mid-May	**Pentecost: The Holy Spirit**	+150 95, 97, 100 · FC 204 · Pr. 12
28	May	**My First Holy Communion Is Coming!**	FC 223, 224, 225, 230 · Pr. 21
29	Late May	**Receiving Jesus**	FC 226, 227, 228, 229, 233, 234, 69, 236
30	Early June	**Thank You, Jesus!**	+150 139 · FC 235, 237, 232 · Pr. 20

+150 = 150 Extra Activities · FC = First Communion · Pr. = Catholic Prayers for Children · Stories = Illustrated Bible Stories · Games = Catechism Games. Adjust the weeks to your parish calendar and school breaks. Many parishes celebrate First Communion in late April or May: if yours comes before June, do weeks 28 and 29 right before it.

Week 1

LATE SEPTEMBER

Welcome to Religious Ed!

Goal: Help the children get to know each other, become a group, and begin the year with Jesus by making the Sign of the Cross.

In Class 1 hour

15 min	**Welcome**	Sit in a circle and play the name games so everyone learns the others' names. → **"Welcome to Religious Ed: The Name Game" (150 Extra Activities, p. 115)**
10 min	**Discover**	Each child fills in "All About Me," then shares it with the group. → **"All About Me" (150 Extra Activities, p. 119)**
20 min	**Activity**	Read "Our Class Promise" together, check the rules you choose, and have everyone sign it. Children who finish early can color the Sign of the Cross page. → **"Our Class Promise" (150 Extra Activities, p. 121)** → **"I Make the Sign of the Cross" (First Communion, p. 72)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Learn to make the Sign of the Cross slowly, all together. → **"The Sign of the Cross" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 1)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Fill in "All About Me" together, color the Sign of the Cross page, and make the Sign of the Cross as a family before meals.

→ **"All About Me" (150 Extra Activities, p. 119)**
→ **"I Make the Sign of the Cross" (First Communion, p. 72)**
→ **"The Sign of the Cross" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 1)**

The Question of the Week

What would you like to learn about Jesus this year?

Something to Do at Home

Make the Sign of the Cross as a family before every meal this week.

To Print: "Welcome to Religious Ed: The Name Game" (150 Extra Activities, p. 115): 1 for the adult · "All About Me" (150 Extra Activities, p. 119): 1 per child · "Our Class Promise" (150 Extra Activities, p. 121): 1 for the group · "I Make the Sign of the Cross" (First Communion, p. 72): 1 per child

Week 2

EARLY OCTOBER

God Creates the World

Goal: Help the children discover that everything that exists comes from God, who created it all out of love, including us.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Ask each child what they find most beautiful in nature, then read the illustrated story of Creation together. → **"The Creation of the World" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 4)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of Creation and answer the questions together. → **"The Creation of the World" (First Communion, p. 5)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child numbers the seven days of Creation. Then read "What God Tells Us" and talk about it together. → **"The Seven Days of Creation" (First Communion, p. 6)** → **"What God Tells Us" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 5)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Each child thanks God for one thing God made, then everyone prays the Glory Be together. → **"The Glory Be" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 4)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the illustrated story of Creation, number the seven days, and pray the Glory Be.
→ **"The Creation of the World" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 4)**
→ **"The Seven Days of Creation" (First Communion, p. 6)**
→ **"The Glory Be" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 4)**

The Question of the Week

What has God made that you love most, and how can you take care of it?

Something to Do at Home

Take a walk as a family and thank God for what you see.

To Print: "The Creation of the World" (First Communion, p. 5): 1 per child · "The Seven Days of Creation" (First Communion, p. 6): 1 per child · "What God Tells Us" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 5): 1 per child · "The Creation of the World" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 4): 1 for the adult

Week 3

OCTOBER

Adam, Eve, and Noah: God Makes a Covenant

Goal: Help the children understand that even when people turn away from him, God stays faithful and makes a covenant with them.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Retell the story of Creation in a few words. Ask the children, "What is a promise?"
20 min	**Discover**	Read the story of Adam and Eve, then the story of Noah, and answer the questions together. → **"Adam and Eve in the Garden of Eden" (First Communion, p. 7)** → **"Noah and the Ark" (First Communion, p. 8)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child colors the animals going into the ark. Remind them that the rainbow is the sign of God's covenant. → **"The Animals Enter the Ark" (First Communion, p. 9)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Learn Grace Before Meals, the prayer that thanks God before we eat. → **"Grace Before Meals" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 10)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the illustrated story of Noah's Ark, color the ark, and say Grace Before Meals at dinner.

→ **"Noah's Ark" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 8)**
→ **"The Animals Enter the Ark" (First Communion, p. 9)**
→ **"Grace Before Meals" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 10)**

The Question of the Week

What does the rainbow that God shows Noah mean?

Something to Do at Home

Say Grace Before Meals together at every meal this week.

To Print: "Adam and Eve in the Garden of Eden" (First Communion, p. 7): 1 per child · "Noah and the Ark" (First Communion, p. 8): 1 per child · "The Animals Enter the Ark" (First Communion, p. 9): 1 per child

Week 4

MID-OCTOBER

Abraham and Moses: God Guides His People

Goal: Help the children discover that God calls Abraham and Moses, and that he guides his people when they trust him.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	One child crosses the room with eyes closed, guided by another child's voice. Ask, "Who do you trust?"
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of Abraham and answer the questions together. → **"God Makes a Covenant With Abraham" (First Communion, p. 10)**
25 min	**Activity**	In two groups, read the story of baby Moses saved from the water and the story of the Red Sea, then each group tells its story to the other. → **"Baby Moses Is Saved From the Water" (First Communion, p. 11)** → **"Crossing the Red Sea" (First Communion, p. 12)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Morning Offering together to offer the day to God. → **"Morning Offering" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 8)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read one illustrated story each night, Abraham and then the Red Sea, and pray the Morning Offering when you wake up.

→ **"Abraham, the Friend of God" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 10)**

→ **"Crossing the Red Sea" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 16)**

→ **"Morning Offering" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 8)**

The Question of the Week

How does God help you when you're scared or don't know what to do?

Something to Do at Home

Each morning at breakfast, offer your day to God in one sentence.

To Print: "God Makes a Covenant With Abraham" (First Communion, p. 10): 1 per child · "Baby Moses Is Saved From the Water" (First Communion, p. 11): 1 per child · "Crossing the Red Sea" (First Communion, p. 12): 1 per child

Week 5

OCTOBER

The Ten Commandments

Goal: Help the children understand that the Ten Commandments are a gift from God to teach us how to love.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Recall how God led his people out of Egypt. Ask, "What are the rules of a game for?"
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of Moses receiving the Ten Commandments and answer the questions together. → **"Moses Receives the Ten Commandments" (First Communion, p. 175)**
25 min	**Activity**	Read the Ten Commandments explained for children, then each child matches each commandment to an example from their own life. → **"The Ten Commandments Explained to Children" (First Communion, p. 177)** → **"Each Commandment and an Example From My Life" (First Communion, p. 179)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Love together. → **"Act of Love" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 20)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color Moses with the two tablets, then cut out the tablets to hang in the child's bedroom.

→ **"Moses and the Ten Commandments" (First Communion, p. 176)**

→ **"My Ten Commandments Tablets to Cut Out" (First Communion, p. 192)**

The Question of the Week

Which commandment is the hardest for you, and why?

Something to Do at Home

Each evening, choose one commandment together and talk about how you lived it that day.

To Print: "Moses Receives the Ten Commandments" (First Communion, p. 175): 1 per child · "The Ten Commandments Explained to Children" (First Communion, p. 177): 1 per child · "Each Commandment and an Example From My Life" (First Communion, p. 179): 1 per child

Week 6

LATE OCTOBER

Love God and Your Neighbor

Goal: Help the children discover that Jesus sums up the whole Law in two commandments: love God and love your neighbor.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Ask each child to tell about a time when someone helped them.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of the Greatest Commandment and answer the questions together. → **"The Greatest Commandment" (First Communion, p. 185)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child checks what they would do in each situation, and you talk it over. Then each one chooses a good deed for every day. → **"What Would You Do in This Situation?" (First Communion, p. 187)** → **"My Good Deed of the Week" (First Communion, p. 188)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Bedtime Prayer together. → **"Bedtime Prayer" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 9)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the story of the Good Samaritan, write down each day's good deed, and pray the Bedtime Prayer.
→ **"The Good Samaritan" (First Communion, p. 29)**
→ **"My Good Deed of the Week" (First Communion, p. 188)**
→ **"Bedtime Prayer" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 9)**

The Question of the Week

Who is your neighbor this week, and how will you love them?

Something to Do at Home

In the evening, everyone tells about the good deed they did that day.

To Print: "The Greatest Commandment" (First Communion, p. 185): 1 per child · "What Would You Do in This Situation?" (First Communion, p. 187): 1 per child · "My Good Deed of the Week" (First Communion, p. 188): 1 per child

Week 7

EARLY NOVEMBER

All Saints' Day: All Called to Be Saints

All Saints' Day: Sunday, November 1, 2026 · All Souls' Day: November 2

Goal: Help the children discover that the saints are God's friends and that each of us is called to become a saint.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Each child colors the great family of saints in heaven. → **"All the Saints in Heaven" (150 Extra Activities, p. 122)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the riddles aloud and guess together which saint is hiding behind each one. → **"Guess Which Saint I Am" (150 Extra Activities, p. 125)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child fills in the page about their patron saint. If they don't know who it is, help them find out. → **"My Patron Saint and Me" (150 Extra Activities, p. 127)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Read the page about All Souls' Day and pray for those who have died, then pray the Apostles' Creed together. → **"All Souls' Day: Praying for Our Loved Ones Who Have Died" (150 Extra Activities, p. 128)** → **"The Apostles' Creed" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 5)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Look up the child's patron saint together, finish the page, then do the All Saints' Day word search.

→ **"My Patron Saint and Me" (150 Extra Activities, p. 127)**

→ **"All Saints' Day Words" (150 Extra Activities, p. 129)**

The Question of the Week

Which saint would you like to be like, and why?

Something to Do at Home

On November 2, light a candle and pray for the members of your family who have died.

To Print: "All the Saints in Heaven" (150 Extra Activities, p. 122): 1 per child · "Guess Which Saint I Am" (150 Extra Activities, p. 125): 1 per child · "My Patron Saint and Me" (150 Extra Activities, p. 127): 1 per child · "All Souls' Day: Praying for Our Loved Ones Who Have Died" (150 Extra Activities, p. 128): 1 for the adult

Week 8

NOVEMBER

Jesus Teaches Us to Pray

Goal: Help the children understand that praying means talking to God our Father, and learn the Our Father, the prayer Jesus taught us.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Ask, "Who do you talk to when you're happy or sad? And what do you say to God?"
15 min	**Discover**	Read "Why Do We Pray?" and answer the questions together. → **"Why Do We Pray?" (First Communion, p. 70)**
25 min	**Activity**	Read the page about the Our Father, then each child puts the lines of the prayer back in order. → **"The Our Father, the Prayer of Jesus" (First Communion, p. 73)** → **"Put the Our Father in Order" (First Communion, p. 75)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Our Father together, slowly. → **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Complete the Our Father, draw the prayer corner the child dreams of, and pray the Our Father at bedtime.
→ **"The Our Father" (First Communion, p. 74)**
→ **"My Prayer Corner" (First Communion, p. 92)**
→ **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**

The Question of the Week
What would you like to tell God tonight?

Something to Do at Home
Set up a small prayer corner at home and pray the Our Father there at bedtime.

To Print: "Why Do We Pray?" (First Communion, p. 70): 1 per child · "The Our Father, the Prayer of Jesus" (First Communion, p. 73): 1 per child · "Put the Our Father in Order" (First Communion, p. 75): 1 per child

Week 9

MID-NOVEMBER

Mary, Our Mother

Goal: Help the children get to know Mary, the mother of Jesus, who is our mother too and prays for us.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Ask the children what they know about Mary. Show a picture or a statue of Mary if you have one.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the Hail Mary and answer the questions together. → **"Learning the Hail Mary" (First Communion, p. 77)**
25 min	**Activity**	Read "What Is the Rosary?" and answer the questions, then each child colors Mary, our mother. → **"What Is the Rosary?" (First Communion, p. 95)** → **"Mary, Our Mother" (First Communion, p. 79)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray a Hail Mary together. → **"The Hail Mary" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 3)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Complete the Hail Mary, color the rosary, and pray a few Hail Marys together.
→ **"The Hail Mary" (First Communion, p. 78)**
→ **"The Rosary to Color" (First Communion, p. 96)**
→ **"The Hail Mary" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 3)**

The Question of the Week

What would you like to ask Mary to pray for?

Something to Do at Home

Each evening, pray a Hail Mary as a family for someone who needs it. At Thanksgiving dinner, thank God together for your family.

To Print: "Learning the Hail Mary" (First Communion, p. 77): 1 per child · "What Is the Rosary?" (First Communion, p. 95): 1 per child · "Mary, Our Mother" (First Communion, p. 79): 1 per child

Week 10

EARLY DECEMBER

Advent: We Get Our Hearts Ready

First Sunday of Advent: November 29, 2026

Goal: Help the children understand that Advent is a time of joyful waiting: we get our hearts ready to welcome Jesus at Christmas.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	If you have an Advent wreath, light the first candle. Read the First Sunday of Advent prayer together. → **"A Prayer for Lighting Each Candle of the Wreath" (150 Extra Activities, p. 7)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about Advent and answer the questions together. → **"Advent" (First Communion, p. 198)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child colors the Advent wreath. Children who finish early can do the Advent Word Search. → **"The Advent Wreath" (First Communion, p. 199)** → **"Advent Words" (150 Extra Activities, p. 9)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Hope together. → **"Act of Hope" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 19)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the page about Advent, color the first box of the Advent calendar, and pray the Act of Hope at bedtime.

→ **"Advent" (First Communion, p. 198)**
→ **"The Advent Coloring Calendar, One Box a Day" (150 Extra Activities, p. 5)**
→ **"Act of Hope" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 19)**

The Question of the Week
What can you do this week to get your heart ready for Christmas?

Something to Do at Home
Each Sunday of Advent, light one more candle as a family.

To Print: "The Advent Wreath" (First Communion, p. 199): 1 per child · "Advent Words" (150 Extra Activities, p. 9): 1 per child · "A Prayer for Lighting Each Candle of the Wreath" (150 Extra Activities, p. 7): 1 for the adult

Week 11

DECEMBER

The Annunciation: Mary Says Yes

The Immaculate Conception: Tuesday, December 8, 2026 (holy day of obligation)

Goal: Help the children discover that Mary says yes to God, and that we can say yes to him too during Advent.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the illustrated story of the Annunciation together and take a good look at the picture. → **"The Annunciation" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 24)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of the Annunciation and answer the questions together. → **"The Annunciation" (First Communion, p. 16)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child colors the angel Gabriel and Mary. Introduce the feast of December 8, the patronal feast of the United States. Children who finish early can color the Immaculate Conception. → **"The Angel Gabriel Brings the Good News to Mary" (150 Extra Activities, p. 11)** → **"The Immaculate Conception (December 8)" (150 Extra Activities, p. 130)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Angelus together: it recalls Mary's yes. → **"The Angelus" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 15)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read "What God Tells Us" about the Annunciation, color the Immaculate Conception, and pray the Angelus.

→ **"What God Tells Us" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 25)**
→ **"The Immaculate Conception (December 8)" (150 Extra Activities, p. 130)**
→ **"The Angelus" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 15)**

The Question of the Week

How can you say yes to God this week?

Something to Do at Home

On December 8, go to Mass as a family: it is a holy day of obligation and the feast of the patroness of the United States.

To Print: "The Annunciation" (First Communion, p. 16): 1 per child · "The Angel Gabriel Brings the Good News to Mary" (150 Extra Activities, p. 11): 1 per child · "The Immaculate Conception (December 8)" (150 Extra Activities, p. 130): 1 per child · "The Annunciation" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 24): 1 for the adult

Week 12

LATE DECEMBER

Christmas: Jesus Comes Among Us

Christmas: Friday, December 25, 2026

Goal: Help the children understand that at Christmas, God becomes a little child: Jesus comes to live among us.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Ask the children how their families get ready for Christmas.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of the birth of Jesus and answer the questions together. → **"The Birth of Jesus" (First Communion, p. 17)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child colors and cuts out a Nativity scene: the stable, then Mary, Joseph, and Baby Jesus, then the shepherds and the animals. Keep Baby Jesus aside until Christmas Eve. → **"The Nativity Scene to Cut Out (1): The Stable and the Manger" (150 Extra Activities, p. 19)** → **"The Nativity Scene to Cut Out (2): Mary, Joseph, and Baby Jesus" (150 Extra Activities, p. 20)** → **"The Nativity Scene to Cut Out (3): The Shepherds, the Donkey, and the Ox" (150 Extra Activities, p. 21)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Fill in the blanks of the Glory to God, the song of the angels, then say it together. → **"Glory to God: A Hymn of Praise" (First Communion, p. 120)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Do the crossword of the people in the Christmas story, set up the Nativity scene, and say the prayer at the Nativity scene on Christmas Eve.

→ **"The People in the Christmas Story: Crossword" (First Communion, p. 18)**

→ **"My Prayer at the Nativity Scene" (150 Extra Activities, p. 30)**

The Question of the Week

What gift can you give Jesus for Christmas?

Something to Do at Home

On Christmas Eve, place Baby Jesus in the manger together and pray in front of the Nativity scene.

To Print: "The Birth of Jesus" (First Communion, p. 17): 1 per child · "The Nativity Scene to Cut Out (1): The Stable and the Manger" (150 Extra Activities, p. 19): 1 per child · "The Nativity Scene to Cut Out (2): Mary, Joseph, and Baby Jesus" (150 Extra Activities, p. 20): 1 per child · "The Nativity Scene to Cut Out (3): The Shepherds, the Donkey, and the Ox" (150 Extra Activities, p. 21): 1 per child · "Glory to God: A Hymn of Praise" (First Communion, p. 120): 1 per child

Week 13

EARLY JANUARY

The Epiphany: The Wise Men Follow the Star

The Epiphany: Sunday, January 3, 2027

Goal: Help the children discover that Jesus came for all peoples: the Wise Men travel from far away to worship him.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Each child helps the Wise Men follow the star to Jesus. → **"Follow the Star to Jesus" (150 Extra Activities, p. 36)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of the visit of the Wise Men and answer the questions together. → **"The Visit of the Wise Men" (First Communion, p. 19)**
25 min	**Activity**	Cut out the cards of the Wise Men card game and play in teams. → **"The Wise Men Card Game: 20 Questions About Epiphany" (150 Extra Activities, p. 37)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Faith together. → **"Act of Faith" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 18)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Do the riddles about gold, frankincense, and myrrh, then pray the Act of Faith as a family.

→ **"Why Gold, Frankincense, and Myrrh?" (150 Extra Activities, p. 38)**

→ **"Act of Faith" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 18)**

The Question of the Week

If you were one of the Wise Men, what gift would you bring Jesus?

Something to Do at Home

Bless your front door with chalk as a family (20 + C + M + B + 27) and tell the story of the Wise Men together.

To Print: "Follow the Star to Jesus" (150 Extra Activities, p. 36): 1 per child · "The Visit of the Wise Men" (First Communion, p. 19): 1 per child · "The Wise Men Card Game: 20 Questions About Epiphany" (150 Extra Activities, p. 37): 1 for the group

Week 14

JANUARY

The Baptism of Jesus and My Baptism

The Baptism of the Lord: Sunday, January 10, 2027

Goal: Help the children discover the Baptism of Jesus and understand that through Baptism, we become children of God.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the illustrated story of the Baptism of Jesus together. → **"The Baptism of Jesus" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 30)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of the Baptism of Jesus, then the page about the day of Baptism, and answer the questions. → **"The Baptism of Jesus" (First Communion, p. 21)** → **"The Day of My Baptism" (First Communion, p. 42)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child matches the signs of Baptism to their meaning. Children who finish early can decorate the baptismal candle. → **"The Signs of Baptism: Water, Oil, Candle, White Garment" (First Communion, p. 43)** → **"My Baptismal Candle" (First Communion, p. 50)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Make the Sign of the Cross together, slowly, thinking of your Baptism. → **"The Sign of the Cross" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 1)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Find out about the child's Baptism by asking parents and godparents, then color the Baptism of a baby.

→ **"Find Out About My Baptism" (First Communion, p. 47)**

→ **"The Baptism of a Baby" (First Communion, p. 45)**

The Question of the Week

Who was there on the day of your Baptism, and what did it change for you?

Something to Do at Home

Find the date of each person's Baptism and mark it on the family calendar.

To Print: "The Baptism of Jesus" (First Communion, p. 21): 1 per child · "The Day of My Baptism" (First Communion, p. 42): 1 per child · "The Signs of Baptism: Water, Oil, Candle, White Garment" (First Communion, p. 43): 1 per child · "My Baptismal Candle" (First Communion, p. 50): 1 per child · "The Baptism of Jesus" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 30): 1 for the adult

Week 15

LATE JANUARY

The Seven Sacraments

Goal: Help the children discover the seven sacraments, signs of God's love that stay with us all through life.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Ask, "What signs of love do you receive from your family?" Explain that God gives us signs too.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the seven sacraments and answer the questions together. → **"The Seven Sacraments: Gifts From God" (First Communion, p. 35)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child matches each symbol to its sacrament, then checks the correct answers about the sacraments of Christian initiation. → **"Each Sacrament and Its Symbol" (First Communion, p. 37)** → **"The Sacraments of Christian Initiation" (First Communion, p. 38)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Glory Be together. → **"The Glory Be" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 4)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Find the seven sacraments in the word search, color the sacraments picture, or play the memory game.

→ **"Find the Seven Sacraments" (First Communion, p. 36)**

→ **"Color the Seven Sacraments" (First Communion, p. 39)**

→ **"The Seven Sacraments and the Church" (Catechism Games, p. 22)**

The Question of the Week

Which sacraments have you already received, and which one will you receive soon?

Something to Do at Home

Look at photos of a Baptism or a wedding as a family and tell the story of that day.

To Print: "The Seven Sacraments: Gifts From God" (First Communion, p. 35): 1 per child · "Each Sacrament and Its Symbol" (First Communion, p. 37): 1 per child · "The Sacraments of Christian Initiation" (First Communion, p. 38): 1 per child

Week 16

EARLY FEBRUARY

The Miracles of Jesus

Goal: Help the children discover that the miracles of Jesus show that he is the Son of God and that he takes care of us.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the illustrated story of the Wedding at Cana together. → **"The Wedding at Cana" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 32)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of the Wedding at Cana and answer the questions together. → **"The Wedding at Cana" (First Communion, p. 22)**
25 min	**Activity**	In two groups, read how Jesus calms the storm and how he feeds the five thousand, then each group tells the other about its miracle. → **"Jesus Calms the Storm" (First Communion, p. 25)** → **"Jesus Feeds the Five Thousand" (First Communion, p. 26)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Faith together. → **"Act of Faith" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 18)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Complete the story of the five loaves and two fish, then read the illustrated story of Jesus calming the storm.

→ **"Five Loaves and Two Fish" (First Communion, p. 27)**

→ **"Jesus Calms the Storm" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 36)**

The Question of the Week

If you had been in the boat during the storm, what would you have said to Jesus?

Something to Do at Home

At dinner, thank Jesus for one thing he did for your family this week.

To Print: "The Wedding at Cana" (First Communion, p. 22): 1 per child · "Jesus Calms the Storm" (First Communion, p. 25): 1 per child · "Jesus Feeds the Five Thousand" (First Communion, p. 26): 1 per child · "The Wedding at Cana" (Illustrated Bible Stories, p. 32): 1 for the adult

Week 17

FEBRUARY

Lent: Pray, Fast, Give

Ash Wednesday: February 10, 2027

Goal: Help the children understand that Lent is a forty-day journey to Easter to grow closer to God and to others.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Each child colors the Ash Wednesday scene. Explain why we receive a cross of ashes on our forehead. → **"Ash Wednesday" (150 Extra Activities, p. 46)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about Lent and answer the questions together. → **"Lent" (First Communion, p. 201)**
25 min	**Activity**	Read about the three paths of Lent: pray, give, and fast. Then each child chooses one Lenten promise for each week, like giving something up. → **"Pray, Give, and Fast: The Three Paths of Lent" (150 Extra Activities, p. 48)** → **"My Lenten Promises" (First Communion, p. 202)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Contrition together. → **"Act of Contrition" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 6)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Make the Lenten path and move one step closer to Easter each day, then do the Lent word search.

→ **"The Lenten Path: 40 Steps to Easter" (150 Extra Activities, p. 44)**

→ **"Lenten Words" (150 Extra Activities, p. 50)**

The Question of the Week

What will you give up or do for others this Lent?

Something to Do at Home

Put a Lenten rice bowl on the table, fill it with coins all through Lent, and give what you collect at Easter.

To Print: "Ash Wednesday" (150 Extra Activities, p. 46): 1 per child · "Lent" (First Communion, p. 201): 1 per child · "Pray, Give, and Fast: The Three Paths of Lent" (150 Extra Activities, p. 48): 1 per child · "My Lenten Promises" (First Communion, p. 202): 1 per child

Week 18

LATE FEBRUARY

God Always Forgives

Goal: Help the children discover, through the Prodigal Son, that God always waits for us and forgives anyone who comes back to him.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Check in on everyone's Lenten promises. Ask, "Is it easy to say you're sorry?"
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of the Prodigal Son and answer the questions together. → **"The Prodigal Son" (First Communion, p. 30)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child colors the father welcoming his son. Children who finish early can do the forgiveness word search. → **"The Father Welcomes His Son" (First Communion, p. 57)** → **"God's Forgiveness: Word Search" (First Communion, p. 55)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Contrition together, slowly. → **"Act of Contrition" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 6)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the story of the Lost Sheep, do the maze on the path of forgiveness, and pray the Act of Contrition.

→ **"The Lost Sheep" (First Communion, p. 31)**
→ **"The Path of Forgiveness" (First Communion, p. 59)**
→ **"Act of Contrition" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 6)**

The Question of the Week

How do you feel when someone forgives you?

Something to Do at Home

Before bedtime, take a moment to forgive each other for the little quarrels of the day.

To Print: "The Prodigal Son" (First Communion, p. 30): 1 per child · "The Father Welcomes His Son" (First Communion, p. 57): 1 per child · "God's Forgiveness: Word Search" (First Communion, p. 55): 1 per child

Week 19

EARLY MARCH

The Sacrament of Reconciliation

Goal: Help the children understand that in the sacrament of Reconciliation, Jesus forgives us through the priest.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Recall the father who waits for his son and forgives him. Explain that Jesus gives us a sacrament to receive that forgiveness.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the sacrament of Reconciliation and answer the questions together. → **"The Sacrament of Reconciliation" (First Communion, p. 52)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child puts the steps of Confession in order, then checks the correct answers about what happens during the sacrament. → **"The Steps of Confession" (First Communion, p. 53)** → **"What Happens During Reconciliation?" (First Communion, p. 56)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Contrition together. → **"Act of Contrition" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 6)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Complete the Act of Contrition and learn it by heart, then do the Reconciliation true or false.

→ **"Complete the Act of Contrition" (First Communion, p. 54)**

→ **"Reconciliation: True or False?" (First Communion, p. 58)**

The Question of the Week

What makes you look forward to Confession, or feel a little nervous about it?

Something to Do at Home

If your parish has a Lenten penance service, go together as a family.

To Print: "The Sacrament of Reconciliation" (First Communion, p. 52): 1 per child · "The Steps of Confession" (First Communion, p. 53): 1 per child · "What Happens During Reconciliation?" (First Communion, p. 56): 1 per child

Week 20

MARCH

My Examination of Conscience

Goal: Help the children learn to look at their lives with Jesus to get ready to receive his forgiveness.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Check in on the Lenten promises and review the steps of Confession.
15 min	**Discover**	Read "What Is an Examination of Conscience?" and answer the questions together. → **"What Is an Examination of Conscience?" (First Communion, p. 213)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child answers the questions about God and about others on their own, in their hearts. Do not read their answers. Then each child cuts out a reminder card for Confession. → **"My Examination of Conscience: Toward God" (First Communion, p. 214)** → **"My Examination of Conscience: Toward Others" (First Communion, p. 215)** → **"My Confession Reminder Card to Cut Out" (First Communion, p. 222)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Bedtime Prayer together. → **"Bedtime Prayer" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 9)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Let the child do the examination of conscience about themselves on their own, then pray at bedtime with three little words: thank you, I'm sorry, please.

→ **"My Examination of Conscience: Toward Myself" (First Communion, p. 216)**

→ **"My Bedtime Prayer: Thank You, I'm Sorry, Please" (First Communion, p. 219)**

The Question of the Week

What would you like to tell Jesus you're sorry for?

Something to Do at Home

Each evening, say thank you, I'm sorry, and please to God as a family.

To Print: "What Is an Examination of Conscience?" (First Communion, p. 213): 1 per child · "My Examination of Conscience: Toward God" (First Communion, p. 214): 1 per child · "My Examination of Conscience: Toward Others" (First Communion, p. 215): 1 per child · "My Confession Reminder Card to Cut Out" (First Communion, p. 222): 1 per child

Week 21

MID-MARCH

Palm Sunday and Holy Week

Palm Sunday: March 21, 2027

Goal: Help the children follow Jesus through Holy Week: he enters Jerusalem, shares his Last Supper, and gives his life out of love.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the story of Palm Sunday and answer the questions together. → **"Palm Sunday" (First Communion, p. 33)**
20 min	**Discover**	Read about the Last Supper, then about Jesus washing his disciples' feet, and answer the questions together. → **"The Last Supper" (First Communion, p. 163)** → **"Jesus Washes His Disciples' Feet" (First Communion, p. 165)**
15 min	**Activity**	Each child colors the cross, the sign of Jesus' love. → **"The Cross, Sign of Jesus' Love" (150 Extra Activities, p. 72)**
10 min	**Prayer**	In front of a cross, keep a moment of silence, then pray the Our Father together. → **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Make a palm branch for Palm Sunday Mass, then match each day of Holy Week to its story.

→ **"My Palm Branch to Make" (150 Extra Activities, p. 61)**

→ **"Match Each Day of Holy Week to Its Story" (150 Extra Activities, p. 68)**

The Question of the Week

What did Jesus do for us out of love during Holy Week?

Something to Do at Home

Go to Palm Sunday Mass as a family, then tuck your palms behind the crucifix at home.

To Print: "Palm Sunday" (First Communion, p. 33): 1 per child · "The Last Supper" (First Communion, p. 163): 1 per child · "Jesus Washes His Disciples' Feet" (First Communion, p. 165): 1 per child · "The Cross, Sign of Jesus' Love" (150 Extra Activities, p. 72): 1 per child

Week 22

LATE MARCH

Easter: Jesus Is Alive!

Easter Sunday: March 28, 2027

Goal: Help the children rejoice in the Resurrection: Jesus is alive, and death does not have the last word.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Ask the children how they celebrated Easter. Light a candle if you have one.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of the Resurrection of Jesus and answer the questions together. → **"The Resurrection of Jesus" (First Communion, p. 34)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child colors the risen Jesus appearing to Mary Magdalene, then the disciples on the road to Emmaus. → **"The Risen Jesus Appears to Mary Magdalene" (150 Extra Activities, p. 77)** → **"The Disciples on the Road to Emmaus" (150 Extra Activities, p. 85)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Glory Be together, joyfully. → **"The Glory Be" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 4)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Do the Easter word search and say the Easter morning prayer when you wake up.
→ **"Alleluia! Easter Words" (150 Extra Activities, p. 81)**
→ **"My Easter Morning Prayer" (150 Extra Activities, p. 84)**

The Question of the Week

What makes you happy when you think that Jesus is alive?

Something to Do at Home

Every morning this week, say "Alleluia!" together at breakfast.

To Print: "The Resurrection of Jesus" (First Communion, p. 34): 1 per child · "The Risen Jesus Appears to Mary Magdalene" (150 Extra Activities, p. 77): 1 per child · "The Disciples on the Road to Emmaus" (150 Extra Activities, p. 85): 1 per child

Week 23

APRIL

The Eucharist: Jesus Really Present

Goal: Help the children understand that in Easter Time, the risen Jesus stays with us: in the Eucharist, he is truly present.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the page about Easter and Easter Time, then answer the questions together. → **"Easter and Easter Time" (First Communion, p. 203)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the Eucharist and answer the questions together. → **"The Eucharist: Jesus Truly Present" (First Communion, p. 60)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child completes the sentences about the bread and wine, then matches the beginnings and endings of the sentences about wheat and bread. → **"The Bread and Wine Become the Body and Blood of Christ" (First Communion, p. 61)** → **"From Wheat to Bread, From Grapes to Wine" (First Communion, p. 64)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Faith together. → **"Act of Faith" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 18)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color the chalice and the host, then do the Eucharist true or false.

→ **"The Chalice and the Host" (First Communion, p. 63)**

→ **"The Eucharist: True or False?" (First Communion, p. 65)**

The Question of the Week

What do you want to tell Jesus when you see him present in the host?

Something to Do at Home

At Sunday Mass, when the priest raises the host, look at it together in silence.

To Print: "Easter and Easter Time" (First Communion, p. 203): 1 per child · "The Eucharist: Jesus Truly Present" (First Communion, p. 60): 1 per child · "The Bread and Wine Become the Body and Blood of Christ" (First Communion, p. 61): 1 per child · "From Wheat to Bread, From Grapes to Wine" (First Communion, p. 64): 1 per child

Week 24

MID-APRIL

The Mass, Part 1: We Listen to God's Word

Goal: Help the children discover how the Mass unfolds and understand that in the readings, God speaks to us.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read "What Is the Mass?" and answer the questions together. → **"What Is the Mass?" (First Communion, p. 115)**
15 min	**Discover**	Each child numbers the four main parts of the Mass, then everyone checks the answers together. → **"The Four Main Parts of the Mass" (First Communion, p. 116)**
25 min	**Activity**	Read the page about the Liturgy of the Word, then each child matches each reading to what we hear in it. → **"The Liturgy of the Word" (First Communion, p. 121)** → **"The Readings at Mass" (First Communion, p. 122)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Apostles' Creed together: at Sunday Mass, we also profess our faith with a creed. → **"The Apostles' Creed" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 5)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

After Sunday Mass, fill in the Mass notebook together: what the child heard and remembers.

→ **"My Mass Notebook: What I Remember" (First Communion, p. 142)**

The Question of the Week

What words do you remember from Mass on Sunday?

Something to Do at Home

On the way home from Mass, have everyone share what they remember from the Gospel.

To Print: "What Is the Mass?" (First Communion, p. 115): 1 per child · "The Four Main Parts of the Mass" (First Communion, p. 116): 1 per child · "The Liturgy of the Word" (First Communion, p. 121): 1 per child · "The Readings at Mass" (First Communion, p. 122): 1 per child

Week 25

LATE APRIL

The Mass, Part 2: The Bread and the Wine

Goal: Help the children understand that at Mass, the bread and wine become the Body and Blood of Christ, whom we receive in Communion.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Review together the four main parts of the Mass from last week.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the Liturgy of the Eucharist and answer the questions together. → **"The Liturgy of the Eucharist" (First Communion, p. 125)**
25 min	**Activity**	Read the page about Communion, then each child colors the Consecration. → **"Communion" (First Communion, p. 130)** → **"The Consecration" (First Communion, p. 128)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Our Father together: we pray it at Mass before Communion. → **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Do the Big Mass Quiz together, then cut out the Mass cards and put them in order.
→ **"The Big Mass Quiz" (First Communion, p. 138)**
→ **"The Mass Cards to Cut Out and Put in Order" (First Communion, p. 144)**

The Question of the Week

Which part of the Mass do you like best, and why?

Something to Do at Home

At Sunday Mass, quietly name each part of the Mass for the child.

To Print: "The Liturgy of the Eucharist" (First Communion, p. 125): 1 per child · "Communion" (First Communion, p. 130): 1 per child · "The Consecration" (First Communion, p. 128): 1 per child

Week 26

EARLY MAY

The Ascension: Jesus Stays With Us

The Ascension: Thursday, May 6 or Sunday, May 9, 2027 (depending on your diocese)

Goal: Help the children understand that by going up to heaven, Jesus does not leave us: he stays with us, present in the tabernacle of our churches.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read together the page about the promise Jesus made before going up to heaven. → **"I Am With You Always" (150 Extra Activities, p. 94)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the objects on the altar and answer the questions together. → **"The Objects on the Altar" (First Communion, p. 145)**
25 min	**Activity**	If you can, go to the church: each child checks off the objects they find. If not, each child matches the priest's vestments to their names. → **"I Visit My Church: A Scavenger Hunt" (First Communion, p. 160)** → **"The Priest's Vestments: Alb, Stole, Chasuble" (First Communion, p. 150)**
5 min	**Prayer**	May is Mary's month, when many parishes crown her statue: pray the Memorare together. → **"The Memorare" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 14)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color the ciborium and the tabernacle, then do the Ascension word search.

→ **"The Ciborium and the Tabernacle" (First Communion, p. 148)**

→ **"Ascension Words" (150 Extra Activities, p. 92)**

The Question of the Week

Where can you meet Jesus, now that he has gone up to heaven?

Something to Do at Home

On the day of the Ascension, stop by a church for a few minutes to greet Jesus in the tabernacle.

To Print: "I Am With You Always" (150 Extra Activities, p. 94): 1 per child · "The Objects on the Altar" (First Communion, p. 145): 1 per child · "I Visit My Church: A Scavenger Hunt" (First Communion, p. 160): 1 per child · "The Priest's Vestments: Alb, Stole, Chasuble" (First Communion, p. 150): 1 per child

Week 27

MID-MAY

Pentecost: The Holy Spirit

Pentecost: Sunday, May 16, 2027

Goal: Help the children discover that at Pentecost, the Holy Spirit comes down on the Apostles and gives them the strength to tell everyone about Jesus.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Each child colors the Holy Spirit coming down on the Apostles. → **"The Holy Spirit Comes Down on the Apostles" (150 Extra Activities, p. 95)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of Pentecost and answer the questions together. → **"Pentecost" (First Communion, p. 204)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child colors, cuts out, and puts together the crown of the seven gifts of the Holy Spirit. → **"The Crown of the Seven Gifts" (150 Extra Activities, p. 97)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray "Come, Holy Spirit" together. → **"Come, Holy Spirit" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 12)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Match each symbol of the Holy Spirit to its sentence, then pray "Come, Holy Spirit" every morning.
→ **"Wind, Fire, Dove: The Symbols of the Holy Spirit" (150 Extra Activities, p. 100)**
→ **"Come, Holy Spirit" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 12)**

The Question of the Week

What would you like to ask the Holy Spirit to give you strength for?

Something to Do at Home

Every morning this week, call on the Holy Spirit as a family before you leave the house.

To Print: "The Holy Spirit Comes Down on the Apostles" (150 Extra Activities, p. 95): 1 per child · "Pentecost" (First Communion, p. 204): 1 per child · "The Crown of the Seven Gifts" (150 Extra Activities, p. 97): 1 per child

Week 28

MAY

My First Holy Communion Is Coming!

Goal: Help the children get ready with joy for their First Holy Communion and recognize the people who help them grow in faith.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Ask each child how they feel as their First Holy Communion gets closer.
15 min	**Discover**	Read "My First Communion Is Coming Soon!" and answer the questions together. → **"My First Communion Is Coming Soon!" (First Communion, p. 223)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child completes their portrait as a future first communicant, then the page about their family and the people who share their faith. → **"My Portrait as a Future First Communicant" (First Communion, p. 224)** → **"My Family and the People Who Share My Faith" (First Communion, p. 225)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Prayer to the Holy Family together. → **"Prayer to the Holy Family" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 21)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Do the First Communion true or false, then pray together for your family.
→ **"My First Communion: True or False?" (First Communion, p. 230)**
→ **"Prayer to the Holy Family" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 21)**

The Question of the Week
Who helps you grow in faith, and how can you thank them?

Something to Do at Home
Invite the child's godparents to the First Communion Mass, or write them a short note.

To Print: "My First Communion Is Coming Soon!" (First Communion, p. 223): 1 per child · "My Portrait as a Future First Communicant" (First Communion, p. 224): 1 per child · "My Family and the People Who Share My Faith" (First Communion, p. 225): 1 per child

Week 29

LATE MAY

Receiving Jesus

Goal: Help the children learn how to receive Jesus in Communion, with reverence and with joy.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the page about receiving Communion in the hand or on the tongue and answer the questions together. → **"Receiving Communion in the Hand or on the Tongue" (First Communion, p. 226)**
15 min	**Discover**	Each child puts the steps for receiving Communion in order, then everyone acts them out together. → **"How to Receive Communion, Step by Step" (First Communion, p. 227)**
25 min	**Activity**	Each child matches each moment to what they do, then completes the sentences about fasting before Communion. → **"Before, During, and After Communion" (First Communion, p. 228)** → **"Fasting Before Communion" (First Communion, p. 229)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Each child starts writing a prayer of thanksgiving for after Communion. → **"My Prayer of Thanksgiving After Communion" (First Communion, p. 233)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Write the letter to Jesus, prepare what the child wants to tell him after Communion, and keep the keepsake certificate for the big day.

→ **"My Letter to Jesus" (First Communion, p. 234)**

→ **"What I Want to Tell Jesus When I Receive Communion" (First Communion, p. 69)**

→ **"Keepsake Certificate" (First Communion, p. 236)**

The Question of the Week

What would you like to tell Jesus when you receive him for the first time?

Something to Do at Home

The night before the First Communion Mass, pray together for all the children who will receive Jesus for the first time.

To Print: "Receiving Communion in the Hand or on the Tongue" (First Communion, p. 226): 1 per child · "How to Receive Communion, Step by Step" (First Communion, p. 227): 1 per child · "Before, During, and After Communion" (First Communion, p. 228): 1 per child · "Fasting Before Communion" (First Communion, p. 229): 1 per child · "My Prayer of Thanksgiving After Communion" (First Communion, p. 233): 1 per child

Week 30

EARLY JUNE

Thank You, Jesus!

Goal: Help the children give thanks for the year spent with Jesus and keep the memory of their First Communion in their hearts.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Look back together at the big moments of the year: the first class, Christmas, Easter, and First Communion.
15 min	**Discover**	Form teams and play the Great Liturgical Year Quiz. → **"The Great Liturgical Year Quiz" (150 Extra Activities, p. 139)**
20 min	**Activity**	Each child draws the best moment of their First Communion or glues in a keepsake photo. → **"A Keepsake of My First Communion" (First Communion, p. 235)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Each child thanks Jesus for the year, then everyone prays the Act of Love together. → **"Act of Love" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 20)**
5 min	**Closing**	Thank each child, ask the question of the week, and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color "Jesus, I Welcome You Into My Heart" and the day of First Communion, then hang them up in the child's bedroom.

→ **"Jesus, I Welcome You Into My Heart" (First Communion, p. 237)**

→ **"The Day of My First Communion" (First Communion, p. 232)**

The Question of the Week

What is your favorite memory of this year with Jesus?

Something to Do at Home

Display the keepsake certificate at home and thank God together at dinner.

To Print: "The Great Liturgical Year Quiz" (150 Extra Activities, p. 139): 1 for the adult · "A Keepsake of My First Communion" (First Communion, p. 235): 1 per child

Confirmation: Your Year at a Glance

Weeks 1-15, from late September to late January. Each week has its own page after these two.

Week	When	Theme	Kit Pages
1	Late September	**Welcome to the Journey**	+150 115, 121, 117, 118 · Conf. 5, 6, 225, 226
2	Early October	**My Baptism, the Starting Point**	Conf. 21, 74, 76, 80, 75, 73, 94
3	October	**The Creed, the Faith of the Church**	Conf. 70, 51, 53, 67, 52 · Pr. 5, 18
4	Mid-October	**God the Father and Creator**	Conf. 54, 58, 57, 185, 228 · Pr. 4
5	October	**Jesus Christ, the Son of God**	Conf. 55, 59 · Games 8 · Pr. 22, 3 · +150 136, 135
6	Late October	**I Believe in the Church and in Eternal Life**	Conf. 62, 64, 65, 68, 66, 69, 72
7	Early November	**All Saints' Day: All Called to Be Saints**	+150 125, 124, 128 · Conf. 167, 63, 168, 192, 201
8	November	**My Patron Saint, My Name**	Conf. 197, 175, 14, 15, 202, 198 · Pr. 1
9	Mid-November	**My Letter to the Bishop and My Sponsor**	Conf. 10, 11, 12, 20, 13, 216 · Pr. 2
10	Early December	**Advent: The Prophets Announce the Messiah**	+150 7, 17, 13, 4 · Conf. 218, 137 · Pr. 19
11	December	**Advent: Mary Says Yes**	Conf. 183, 184 · +150 137, 18 · Pr. 3, 16
12	Late December	**Christmas: God Becomes Man**	+150 31, 149, 30, 25 · Conf. 230
13	Early January	**The Epiphany: Christ for All**	+150 37, 38, 34 · Conf. 222, 194 · Pr. 2
14	January	**Moses and the Gift of the Law**	Conf. 96, 95, 97, 98, 117 · Pr. 20 · Games 16
15	Late January	**Love God, Keep Sunday Holy**	Conf. 99, 100, 110, 78, 77, 92 · +150 107

+150 = 150 Extra Activities · Conf. = Confirmation · Pr. = Catholic Prayers for Children · Games = Catechism Games. Adjust the weeks to your parish calendar and school breaks. The age for Confirmation varies by diocese: if your celebration comes before June, do weeks 28 and 29 right before it.

Confirmation: Your Year at a Glance

Weeks 16-30, from early February to early June.

Week	When	Theme	Kit Pages
16	Early February	**Love Your Neighbor**	Conf. 101, 102, 112, 108, 104, 105, 109 · Pr. 21
17	February	**Lent: A Change of Heart**	+150 48, 45 · Conf. 147, 135, 120, 149 · Pr. 6
18	Late February	**Lent: God's Forgiveness**	Conf. 162, 81, 119, 82, 172, 234 · Pr. 6
19	Early March	**Lent: Mercy**	Conf. 152, 151, 154, 155, 156, 174, 165 · Pr. 20
20	March	**Lent: Serving Christ in Others**	Conf. 153, 164, 190, 166 · Pr. 2
21	Mid-March	**Palm Sunday and Holy Week**	Conf. 90, 116 · +150 70, 57, 58, 75
22	Late March	**Easter: Christ Is Risen**	+150 83, 86, 84, 88, 89 · Conf. 60
23	April	**The First Christians**	Conf. 205, 206, 207, 208, 221, 181, 182 · Pr. 5
24	Mid-April	**The Beatitudes: Happiness According to Jesus**	Conf. 133, 121, 131, 130, 128, 132, 134 · Games 34 · Pr. 2
25	Late April	**Who Is the Holy Spirit?**	Conf. 25, 26, 49, 56, 79 · Pr. 12
26	Early May	**The Ascension: Jesus Goes Up to Heaven**	+150 93, 94, 91 · Conf. 61, 28, 48
27	Mid-May	**Pentecost: The Spirit Is Given**	Conf. 27, 29, 30, 46, 47 · +150 151, 101
28	May	**The Seven Gifts and the Fruits of the Spirit**	Conf. 31, 32, 35, 37, 39, 43, 42, 44, 41 · Pr. 12
29	Late May	**Getting Ready for Confirmation**	Conf. 7, 8, 16, 19, 17, 236, 50
30	Early June	**Confirmed and Sent: Thank You!**	Conf. 237, 22, 23, 235, 24, 224, 233

+150 = 150 Extra Activities · Conf. = Confirmation · Pr. = Catholic Prayers for Children · Games = Catechism Games. Adjust the weeks to your parish calendar and school breaks. The age for Confirmation varies by diocese: if your celebration comes before June, do weeks 28 and 29 right before it.

Week 1

LATE SEPTEMBER

Welcome to the Journey

Goal: Help the young people get to know one another, become a group, and think about what it means to ask for Confirmation.

In Class 1 hour

15 min	**Welcome**	Play one or two of the name games so that everyone can introduce themselves. → **"Welcome to Religious Ed: The Name Game" (150 Extra Activities, p. 115)**
15 min	**Discover**	Each young person answers the questions about asking for Confirmation alone. Those who want to can share one answer. → **"Why Am I Asking for Confirmation?" (Confirmation, p. 5)**
15 min	**Activity**	Check the correct answers about Confirmation together, then write and sign your class promise. → **"What Is Confirmation?" (Confirmation, p. 6)** → **"Our Class Promise" (150 Extra Activities, p. 121)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Pray the prayer for the new religious ed year together. → **"My Prayer for the New Religious Ed Year" (150 Extra Activities, p. 117)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read how the spiritual journal works, prepare the Morning Offering and the Bedtime Prayer together, then color and cut out the bookmarks.

→ **"My Spiritual Journal: How It Works" (Confirmation, p. 225)**
→ **"My Morning and Bedtime Prayer" (Confirmation, p. 226)**
→ **"My Religious Ed Bookmarks" (150 Extra Activities, p. 118)**

The Question of the Week

Why do you want to receive Confirmation? Say it in your own words.

Something to Do at Home

Pick out a small notebook as a family. It will become your child's spiritual journal.

To Print: "Why Am I Asking for Confirmation?" (Confirmation, p. 5): 1 per child · "What Is Confirmation?" (Confirmation, p. 6): 1 per child · "Our Class Promise" (150 Extra Activities, p. 121): 1 for the group · "My Prayer for the New Religious Ed Year" (150 Extra Activities, p. 117): 1 per child · "Welcome to Religious Ed: The Name Game" (150 Extra Activities, p. 115): 1 for the adult

Week 2

EARLY OCTOBER

My Baptism, the Starting Point

Goal: Help the young people understand that Confirmation completes Baptism: together with the Eucharist, they are the three sacraments of Christian initiation.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Each young person fills in the chain of the people who handed the faith on to them. → **"The Chain of Those Who Handed the Faith On to Me" (Confirmation, p. 21)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the three sacraments of Christian initiation and answer the questions together. → **"The Three Sacraments of Christian Initiation" (Confirmation, p. 74)**
25 min	**Activity**	Complete the diagram of the signs of Baptism, then the table that compares the three sacraments. → **"The Signs of Baptism" (Confirmation, p. 76)** → **"Compare Baptism, Confirmation, and the Eucharist" (Confirmation, p. 80)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Slowly make the Sign of the Cross, as on the day of your Baptism.
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the page about Baptism, complete the diagram of the seven sacraments, and look at which ones your child has already received.

→ **"Baptism" (Confirmation, p. 75)**

→ **"The 7 Sacraments in Three Families" (Confirmation, p. 73)**

→ **"My Life With the Sacraments" (Confirmation, p. 94)**

The Question of the Week

Who helped you get to know Jesus, and why would you like to thank them?

Something to Do at Home

Take out the photos or the candle from your child's Baptism and tell them about that day.

To Print: "The Chain of Those Who Handed the Faith On to Me" (Confirmation, p. 21): 1 per child · "The Three Sacraments of Christian Initiation" (Confirmation, p. 74): 1 per child · "The Signs of Baptism" (Confirmation, p. 76): 1 per child · "Compare Baptism, Confirmation, and the Eucharist" (Confirmation, p. 80): 1 per child

Week 3

OCTOBER

The Creed, the Faith of the Church

Goal: Help the young people discover that the Creed sums up the faith of the Church, the faith they will profess when they renew their baptismal promises at Confirmation.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Think alone, then talk it over: why do we say "I believe"? → **Why Do We Say "I Believe"? (Confirmation, p. 70)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the Creed and answer the questions together. → **"What Is the Creed?" (Confirmation, p. 51)**
25 min	**Activity**	Complete the Apostles' Creed with the words from the box. Those who finish early put the articles of the Creed in order. → **"The Apostles' Creed" (Confirmation, p. 53)** → **"The Articles of the Creed" (Confirmation, p. 67)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Apostles' Creed together. → **"The Apostles' Creed" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 5)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Compare the two forms of the Creed in the table, then pray the Act of Faith together.

→ **"The Apostles' Creed and the Nicene Creed" (Confirmation, p. 52)**

→ **"Act of Faith" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 18)**

The Question of the Week

Which line of the Creed speaks to you the most, and which one makes you wonder?

Something to Do at Home

At Sunday Mass, listen closely to the Creed and say it out loud together.

To Print: Why Do We Say "I Believe"? (Confirmation, p. 70): 1 per child · "What Is the Creed?" (Confirmation, p. 51): 1 per child · "The Apostles' Creed" (Confirmation, p. 53): 1 per child · "The Articles of the Creed" (Confirmation, p. 67): 1 per child

Week 4

MID-OCTOBER

God the Father and Creator

Goal: Help the young people understand that God is a Father who created everything out of love, and that he is one God in three Persons.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Each person names one beautiful thing in creation they saw this week.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the first part of the Creed and answer the questions together. → **"I Believe in God, the Father Almighty" (Confirmation, p. 54)**
25 min	**Activity**	Read the page about God the Creator, then complete the diagram of the Holy Trinity. → **"God, Creator of Heaven and Earth" (Confirmation, p. 58)** → **"The Holy Trinity" (Confirmation, p. 57)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Glory Be together. → **"The Glory Be" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 4)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read about the life of Saint Francis of Assisi, color his portrait, and answer the questions. Start the thank-you page in the journal.

→ **"St. Francis of Assisi" (Confirmation, p. 185)**

→ **"Today I Say Thank You to God" (Confirmation, p. 228)**

The Question of the Week

What would you like to thank God the Creator for today?

Something to Do at Home

Go for a walk as a family and thank God for what you see.

To Print: "I Believe in God, the Father Almighty" (Confirmation, p. 54): 1 per child · "God, Creator of Heaven and Earth" (Confirmation, p. 58): 1 per child · "The Holy Trinity" (Confirmation, p. 57): 1 per child

Week 5

OCTOBER

Jesus Christ, the Son of God

Goal: Help the young people learn the main events in the life of Jesus and discover the rosary in October, the month of the Rosary.

In Class 1 hour

5 min	**Welcome**	Ask everyone what they already know about the life of Jesus.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the second part of the Creed and answer the questions together. → **"I Believe in Jesus Christ, His Only Son" (Confirmation, p. 55)**
20 min	**Activity**	Complete the timeline of the life of Jesus. Those who finish early can do the Twelve Apostles word search. → **"The Life of Jesus" (Confirmation, p. 59)** → **"The Twelve Apostles" (Catechism Games, p. 8)**
15 min	**Prayer**	Explain how to pray the rosary, then reflect together on one or two of the Joyful Mysteries. → **"How to Pray the Rosary" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 22)** → **"The Joyful Mysteries of the Rosary" (150 Extra Activities, p. 136)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Make or color the rosary, then pray one decade together with the Hail Mary.

→ **"My Rosary to Make (October, Month of the Rosary)" (150 Extra Activities, p. 135)**

→ **"The Hail Mary" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 3)**

The Question of the Week

Which moment in the life of Jesus would you have liked to share with him, and why?

Something to Do at Home

Pray one decade of the rosary as a family one evening this week.

To Print: "I Believe in Jesus Christ, His Only Son" (Confirmation, p. 55): 1 per child · "The Life of Jesus" (Confirmation, p. 59): 1 per child · "The Twelve Apostles" (Catechism Games, p. 8): 1 per child · "The Joyful Mysteries of the Rosary" (150 Extra Activities, p. 136): 1 for the adult

Week 6

LATE OCTOBER

I Believe in the Church and in Eternal Life

Goal: Help the young people discover the end of the Creed: the Church, the forgiveness of sins, and the eternal life God promises.

In Class 1 hour

5 min	**Welcome**	Pray together the Creed you learned three weeks ago.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the Church in the Creed and answer the questions together. → **"The Holy Catholic Church" (Confirmation, p. 62)**
25 min	**Activity**	Split the group in two: one half reads the page on forgiveness, the other the page on eternal life, then each half presents. Finish with the Creed quiz. → **"The Forgiveness of Sins" (Confirmation, p. 64)** → **"The Resurrection of the Body and Life Everlasting" (Confirmation, p. 65)** → **"The Creed Quiz" (Confirmation, p. 68)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Pray in silence for those who have died, then pray the Our Father together.
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Do the crossword of the words of the Creed and read the case study about a friend who doesn't believe. Then your child writes the Creed in their own words.

→ **"The Words of the Creed" (Confirmation, p. 66)**

→ **"Explaining My Faith to a Friend Who Doesn't Believe" (Confirmation, p. 69)**

→ **"My Creed in My Own Words" (Confirmation, p. 72)**

The Question of the Week

If you had to explain the Creed to a friend in one sentence, what would you say?

Something to Do at Home

Read together the Creed your child wrote and keep it in their journal.

To Print: "The Holy Catholic Church" (Confirmation, p. 62): 1 per child · "The Forgiveness of Sins" (Confirmation, p. 64): 1 per child · "The Resurrection of the Body and Life Everlasting" (Confirmation, p. 65): 1 per child · "The Creed Quiz" (Confirmation, p. 68): 1 per child

Week 7

EARLY NOVEMBER

All Saints' Day: All Called to Be Saints

All Saints' Day: Sunday, November 1, 2026 · All Souls' Day: November 2

Goal: Help the young people understand that a saint is a friend of God and that everyone is called to holiness, in the communion of saints.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Each young person solves the riddles and finds the names of the saints. → **"Guess Which Saint I Am" (150 Extra Activities, p. 125)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about what a saint is, then the page about the communion of saints. → **"What Is a Saint?" (Confirmation, p. 167)** → **"The Communion of Saints" (Confirmation, p. 63)**
20 min	**Activity**	Complete the diagram of the road to canonization, then play Saints Bingo. → **"The Road to Canonization" (Confirmation, p. 168)** → **"Saints Bingo" (150 Extra Activities, p. 124)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Pray for the loved ones of your families who have died, using the All Souls' Day prayer. → **"All Souls' Day: Praying for Our Loved Ones Who Have Died" (150 Extra Activities, p. 128)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read about the life of Saint Carlo Acutis and answer the questions, then think it over: can you become a saint today?

→ **"St. Carlo Acutis" (Confirmation, p. 192)**

→ **"Can You Become a Saint Today?" (Confirmation, p. 201)**

The Question of the Week

Which saint would you like to have as a friend, and why?

Something to Do at Home

Visit the grave of a loved one, bring flowers, and pray for them as a family.

To Print: "Guess Which Saint I Am" (150 Extra Activities, p. 125): 1 per child · "What Is a Saint?" (Confirmation, p. 167): 1 per child · "The Communion of Saints" (Confirmation, p. 63): 1 per child · "The Road to Canonization" (Confirmation, p. 168): 1 per child · "Saints Bingo" (150 Extra Activities, p. 124): 1 for the group · "All Souls' Day: Praying for Our Loved Ones Who Have Died" (150 Extra Activities, p. 128): 1 per child

Week 8

NOVEMBER

My Patron Saint, My Name

Goal: Help the young people discover their patron saint and start thinking about the saint's name they will choose for Confirmation.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Play the saint riddles: who am I? → **"Who Am I? Saint Riddles" (Confirmation, p. 197)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read about the life of Saint Martin of Tours, color his portrait, and answer the questions. → **"St. Martin of Tours" (Confirmation, p. 175)**
25 min	**Activity**	Read the page about choosing a Confirmation name, then each young person starts researching their patron saint. → **"Choosing My Confirmation Name" (Confirmation, p. 14)** → **"Investigating My Patron Saint" (Confirmation, p. 15)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Each person entrusts their week to their patron saint, then everyone makes the Sign of the Cross together. → **"The Sign of the Cross" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 1)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Finish your research, then fill in the patron saint fact sheet. To go further, match the saints to their symbols.

→ **"My Patron Saint Fact Sheet" (Confirmation, p. 202)**

→ **"The Saints and Their Symbols" (Confirmation, p. 198)**

The Question of the Week

What do you like about the life of your patron saint?

Something to Do at Home

Tell your child why you chose their name.

To Print: "Who Am I? Saint Riddles" (Confirmation, p. 197): 1 per child · "St. Martin of Tours" (Confirmation, p. 175): 1 per child · "Choosing My Confirmation Name" (Confirmation, p. 14): 1 per child · "Investigating My Patron Saint" (Confirmation, p. 15): 1 per child

Week 9

MID-NOVEMBER

My Letter to the Bishop and My Sponsor

Goal: Help the young people understand the role of the bishop and of the sponsor, and start their letter asking for Confirmation.

In Class 1 hour

5 min	**Welcome**	Ask if anyone knows the name of your diocese's bishop.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the role of the bishop and answer the questions together. → **"The Role of the Bishop" (Confirmation, p. 10)**
20 min	**Activity**	Read what the Church asks of a sponsor, then check the qualities of a good sponsor. → **"Choosing My Sponsor" (Confirmation, p. 11)** → **"What Makes a Good Sponsor" (Confirmation, p. 12)**
15 min	**Prayer**	In a quiet moment, each young person begins the letter to the bishop, asking God for help. End by praying the Our Father together. → **"My Letter to the Bishop" (Confirmation, p. 20)** → **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Talk about choosing a sponsor and write them a letter. Then find out about your parish and your diocese.

→ **"My Letter to My Sponsor" (Confirmation, p. 13)**

→ **"My Parish and My Diocese" (Confirmation, p. 216)**

The Question of the Week

Who would you like to have beside you on the day of your Confirmation, and why?

Something to Do at Home

Invite your child's future sponsor to share a family meal. At your Thanksgiving table, thank God for them too.

To Print: "The Role of the Bishop" (Confirmation, p. 10): 1 per child · "Choosing My Sponsor" (Confirmation, p. 11): 1 per child · "What Makes a Good Sponsor" (Confirmation, p. 12): 1 per child · "My Letter to the Bishop" (Confirmation, p. 20): 1 per child · "My Letter to My Sponsor" (Confirmation, p. 13): 1 per child

Week 10

EARLY DECEMBER

Advent: The Prophets Announce the Messiah

First Sunday of Advent: November 29, 2026

Goal: Help the young people understand that Advent opens the liturgical year: a time of waiting when we remember the prophets who announced the Messiah.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	If you have an Advent wreath, light the first candle and read the prayer for the first candle. → **"A Prayer for Lighting Each Candle of the Wreath" (150 Extra Activities, p. 7)**
15 min	**Discover**	Complete the diagram of the liturgical year and its colors. → **"The Liturgical Year and Its Colors" (Confirmation, p. 218)**
25 min	**Activity**	Do the crossword of the prophets. Then start the Jesse Tree and its ornaments. → **"The Prophets Announce the Messiah" (150 Extra Activities, p. 17)** → **"The Jesse Tree and Its Ornaments to Cut Out" (150 Extra Activities, p. 13)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Hope together. → **"Act of Hope" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 19)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the page about hope, then cut out the Advent calendar and open one door each day.

→ **"Hope" (Confirmation, p. 137)**

→ **"The Advent Calendar: 24 Doors to Open" (150 Extra Activities, p. 4)**

The Question of the Week

Deep in your heart, what are you waiting for from God this year?

Something to Do at Home

Each Sunday of Advent, light one more candle as a family.

To Print: "The Liturgical Year and Its Colors" (Confirmation, p. 218): 1 per child · "The Prophets Announce the Messiah" (150 Extra Activities, p. 17): 1 per child · "The Jesse Tree and Its Ornaments to Cut Out" (150 Extra Activities, p. 13): 1 per child · "A Prayer for Lighting Each Candle of the Wreath" (150 Extra Activities, p. 7): 1 for the adult

Week 11

DECEMBER

Advent: Mary Says Yes

The Immaculate Conception: Tuesday, December 8, 2026 (holy day of obligation)

Goal: Help the young people discover Mary, who says yes to God, and the feasts when the Church celebrates her, like the Immaculate Conception on December 8, the patronal feast of the United States.

In Class 1 hour

5 min	**Welcome**	Light this week's candle and ask what everyone knows about Mary.
20 min	**Discover**	Read about the life of the Blessed Virgin Mary, color her portrait, and answer the questions. → **"The Blessed Virgin Mary" (Confirmation, p. 183)**
15 min	**Activity**	Do the crossword of Mary's feasts throughout the year. → **"Mary's Feasts Throughout the Year" (150 Extra Activities, p. 137)**
15 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Hail Mary, then read the Magnificat together. → **"The Hail Mary" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 3)** → **"The Magnificat" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 16)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read about the life of Saint Joseph and answer the questions. Make the little Advent prayer booklet.
→ **"St. Joseph" (Confirmation, p. 184)**
→ **"My Little Advent Prayer Booklet" (150 Extra Activities, p. 18)**

The Question of the Week

What is God asking you to say yes to right now?

Something to Do at Home

On December 8, a holy day of obligation, go to Mass together and pray a Hail Mary as a family.

To Print: "The Blessed Virgin Mary" (Confirmation, p. 183): 1 per child · "Mary's Feasts Throughout the Year" (150 Extra Activities, p. 137): 1 per child · "The Magnificat" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 16): 1 for the adult

Week 12

LATE DECEMBER

Christmas: God Becomes Man

Christmas: Friday, December 25, 2026

Goal: Help the young people understand that at Christmas God comes to live among us in Jesus, born in Bethlehem.

In Class 1 hour

5 min	**Welcome**	Light the candles of the wreath and ask everyone how they are getting ready for Christmas.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the story of the birth of Jesus again, then do the crossword. → **"The Birth of Jesus According to St. Luke" (150 Extra Activities, p. 31)**
25 min	**Activity**	Hand out the roles and act out the short Christmas skit. → **A Christmas Skit: "No Room for Them" (150 Extra Activities, p. 149)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Gather in front of a Nativity scene and say the prayer together. → **"My Prayer at the Nativity Scene" (150 Extra Activities, p. 30)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Color and fold the Christmas card for the family. In the journal, write about a moment when you felt God close.

→ **"My Folding Christmas Card for My Family" (150 Extra Activities, p. 25)**

→ **"The Moments When I Felt God Close" (Confirmation, p. 230)**

The Question of the Week

What gift can you give Jesus for his birthday?

Something to Do at Home

On Christmas, pray as a family in front of the Nativity scene before you open your presents.

To Print: "The Birth of Jesus According to St. Luke" (150 Extra Activities, p. 31): 1 per child · A Christmas Skit: "No Room for Them" (150 Extra Activities, p. 149): 1 per role · "My Prayer at the Nativity Scene" (150 Extra Activities, p. 30): 1 per child

Week 13

EARLY JANUARY

The Epiphany: Christ for All

The Epiphany: Sunday, January 3, 2027

Goal: Help the young people understand that Jesus comes for all peoples, and that the Church brings the Gospel to the whole world.

In Class 1 hour

15 min	**Welcome**	Play the Wise Men card game: 20 questions about the Epiphany. → **"The Wise Men Card Game: 20 Questions About Epiphany" (150 Extra Activities, p. 37)**
10 min	**Discover**	Read the riddles to understand the three gifts of the Wise Men. → **"Why Gold, Frankincense, and Myrrh?" (150 Extra Activities, p. 38)**
25 min	**Activity**	Read the page about missionaries and answer the questions. → **"Missionaries Bring the Gospel to the World" (Confirmation, p. 222)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Our Father together for all the peoples of the earth. → **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Place the saints of the Americas on the timeline: they brought Christ to the peoples of our continent. Then decorate the Wise Men's crown.

→ **"Saints of the Americas Through the Centuries" (Confirmation, p. 194)**

→ **"The Wise Men's Crown to Decorate" (150 Extra Activities, p. 34)**

The Question of the Week

Like the Wise Men, what can you offer Jesus this year?

Something to Do at Home

Bless your front door with chalk (20 + C + M + B + 27) and tell the story of the Wise Men.

To Print: "The Wise Men Card Game: 20 Questions About Epiphany" (150 Extra Activities, p. 37): 1 for the group · "Why Gold, Frankincense, and Myrrh?" (150 Extra Activities, p. 38): 1 per child · "Missionaries Bring the Gospel to the World" (Confirmation, p. 222): 1 per child

Week 14

JANUARY

Moses and the Gift of the Law

The Baptism of the Lord: Sunday, January 10, 2027

Goal: Help the young people understand that the Ten Commandments are a gift from God to live in freedom, by loving him and loving others.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Complete the story of the Exodus with the words from the box. → **"From Egypt to the Promised Land" (Confirmation, p. 96)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about Moses at Mount Sinai and answer the questions together. → **"Moses and the Gift of the Law at Sinai" (Confirmation, p. 95)**
25 min	**Activity**	Complete the diagram of the two tablets, then read the page about the first commandment. → **"The Two Tablets: Love God, Love Your Neighbor" (Confirmation, p. 97)** → **The 1st Commandment: "I am the LORD your God: you shall not have strange Gods before me" (Confirmation, p. 98)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Love together. → **"Act of Love" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 20)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Do the Ten Commandments crossword, then think it over: are the commandments freedom or just rules?

→ **"The Ten Commandments" (Catechism Games, p. 16)**

→ **"The Commandments: Freedom or Rules?" (Confirmation, p. 117)**

The Question of the Week

Do you think a rule can make you freer? Give an example.

Something to Do at Home

Write down together the three most important rules in your family.

To Print: "From Egypt to the Promised Land" (Confirmation, p. 96): 1 per child · "Moses and the Gift of the Law at Sinai" (Confirmation, p. 95): 1 per child · "The Two Tablets: Love God, Love Your Neighbor" (Confirmation, p. 97): 1 per child · The 1st Commandment: "I am the LORD your God: you shall not have strange Gods before me" (Confirmation, p. 98): 1 per child

Week 15

LATE JANUARY

Love God, Keep Sunday Holy

Goal: Help the young people understand the commandments about God and discover Sunday Mass, the heart of Christian life.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the page about the second commandment and answer the questions. → **The 2nd Commandment: "You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain" (Confirmation, p. 99)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the third commandment and answer the questions together. → **The 3rd Commandment: "Remember to keep holy the LORD'S Day" (Confirmation, p. 100)**
25 min	**Activity**	Read the case study about sports, video games, and Sunday Mass and answer together. Then complete the diagram of the main parts of the Mass. → **"Sports, Video Games, and Sunday Mass" (Confirmation, p. 110)** → **"The Main Parts of the Mass" (Confirmation, p. 78)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Say the prayer before the Blessed Sacrament together. → **"My Prayer Before the Blessed Sacrament" (150 Extra Activities, p. 107)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the page about the Eucharist, then talk it over together: why go to Mass every Sunday?

→ **"The Eucharist" (Confirmation, p. 77)**

→ **"Why Go to Mass Every Sunday?" (Confirmation, p. 92)**

The Question of the Week

What helps you, or what keeps you from, going to Mass on Sunday?

Something to Do at Home

Go to Mass as a family on Sunday, then talk about what each of you remembers.

To Print: The 2nd Commandment: "You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain" (Confirmation, p. 99): 1 per child · The 3rd Commandment: "Remember to keep holy the LORD'S Day" (Confirmation, p. 100): 1 per child · "Sports, Video Games, and Sunday Mass" (Confirmation, p. 110): 1 per child · "The Main Parts of the Mass" (Confirmation, p. 78): 1 per child · "My Prayer Before the Blessed Sacrament" (150 Extra Activities, p. 107): 1 per child

Week 16

EARLY FEBRUARY

Love Your Neighbor

Goal: Help the young people understand the commandments that teach us to respect others.

In Class 1 hour

5 min	**Welcome**	Review the two tablets: love God, love your neighbor.
20 min	**Discover**	Half of the group reads the page on the 4th commandment, the other half the page on the 5th, then each half presents theirs. → **The 4th Commandment: "Honor your father and your mother" (Confirmation, p. 101)** → **The 5th Commandment: "You shall not kill" (Confirmation, p. 102)**
20 min	**Activity**	Read the case study about the wallet found on the street and answer together. Then match each situation to its commandment. → **"The Wallet Found on the Street" (Confirmation, p. 112)** → **"The Commandments and Real-Life Situations" (Confirmation, p. 108)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Prayer to the Holy Family together. → **"Prayer to the Holy Family" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 21)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the pages on the 7th and 8th commandments, then the case study "Lying to Protect a Friend?", and answer the questions.

→ **The 7th Commandment: "You shall not steal" (Confirmation, p. 104)**
→ **The 8th Commandment: "You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor" (Confirmation, p. 105)**
→ **"Lying to Protect a Friend?" (Confirmation, p. 109)**

The Question of the Week

Which commandment is the hardest for you to live right now?

Something to Do at Home

Each person does something helpful for another family member without being asked.

To Print: The 4th Commandment: "Honor your father and your mother" (Confirmation, p. 101): 1 per child · The 5th Commandment: "You shall not kill" (Confirmation, p. 102): 1 per child · "The Wallet Found on the Street" (Confirmation, p. 112): 1 per child · "The Commandments and Real-Life Situations" (Confirmation, p. 108): 1 per child

Week 17

FEBRUARY

Lent: A Change of Heart

Ash Wednesday: February 10, 2027

Goal: Help the young people understand that Lent is a time to grow closer to God through prayer, fasting, and giving.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the three paths of Lent, and each young person chooses their own. → **"Pray, Give, and Fast: The Three Paths of Lent" (150 Extra Activities, p. 48)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the capital sins and the virtues that fight them. → **"The Seven Deadly (Capital) Sins and the Virtues That Fight Them" (Confirmation, p. 147)**
25 min	**Activity**	Complete the diagram of the virtues, then each young person writes their rule of life for Lent. → **"Theological Virtues and Cardinal Virtues" (Confirmation, p. 135)** → **"My Rule of Life" (Confirmation, p. 120)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Contrition together. → **"Act of Contrition" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 6)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Start the Lenten calendar, one small effort a day, and take on a virtue challenge for the week.

→ **"My Lenten Calendar: One Small Effort a Day" (150 Extra Activities, p. 45)**

→ **"My Virtue Challenge of the Week" (Confirmation, p. 149)**

The Question of the Week

What will you give up or do this Lent to grow closer to God?

Something to Do at Home

Go together to receive ashes on Ash Wednesday.

To Print: "Pray, Give, and Fast: The Three Paths of Lent" (150 Extra Activities, p. 48): 1 per child · "The Seven Deadly (Capital) Sins and the Virtues That Fight Them" (Confirmation, p. 147): 1 per child · "Theological Virtues and Cardinal Virtues" (Confirmation, p. 135): 1 per child · "My Rule of Life" (Confirmation, p. 120): 1 per child

Week 18

LATE FEBRUARY

Lent: God's Forgiveness

Goal: Help the young people discover the sacrament of Reconciliation and get ready to receive God's forgiveness.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the parable of the Prodigal Son in the Bible (Luke 15) and check the correct answers. → **"The Prodigal Son (Luke 15:11-32)" (Confirmation, p. 162)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about Reconciliation and answer the questions together. → **"Reconciliation" (Confirmation, p. 81)**
25 min	**Activity**	In a quiet moment, each person looks at their life in the light of the Commandments, then gets ready for Confession. → **"Examination of Conscience With the Commandments" (Confirmation, p. 119)** → **"Getting Ready for Confession: Examination of Conscience" (Confirmation, p. 82)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Contrition together. → **"Act of Contrition" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 6)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read about the life of Saint John Vianney, the Curé of Ars, and answer the questions. Your child fills in their forgiveness notebook alone.

→ **"St. John Vianney, the Curé of Ars" (Confirmation, p. 172)**

→ **"My Forgiveness Notebook" (Confirmation, p. 234)**

The Question of the Week

What difference does it make for you to know that God always forgives?

Something to Do at Home

Look up the Confession times at your parish and go together.

To Print: "The Prodigal Son (Luke 15:11-32)" (Confirmation, p. 162): 1 per child · "Reconciliation" (Confirmation, p. 81): 1 per child · "Examination of Conscience With the Commandments" (Confirmation, p. 119): 1 per child · "Getting Ready for Confession: Examination of Conscience" (Confirmation, p. 82): 1 per child

Week 19

EARLY MARCH

Lent: Mercy

Goal: Help the young people understand that God is merciful and calls us to care for others, body and soul.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the parable of the Good Samaritan in the Bible (Luke 10) and check the correct answers. → **"The Good Samaritan (Luke 10:25-37)" (Confirmation, p. 152)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about mercy and answer the questions together. → **"What Is Mercy?" (Confirmation, p. 151)**
25 min	**Activity**	Complete the diagrams of the corporal and spiritual works of mercy, then connect them to everyday life. → **"The 7 Corporal Works of Mercy" (Confirmation, p. 154)** → **"The 7 Spiritual Works of Mercy" (Confirmation, p. 155)** → **"The Corporal Works in Everyday Life" (Confirmation, p. 156)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Act of Love together. → **"Act of Love" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 20)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read about the life of Saint Vincent de Paul and answer the questions. Begin the month of mercy: one small work of mercy each day, checked off on the chart.

→ **"St. Vincent de Paul" (Confirmation, p. 174)**

→ **"My Month of Mercy" (Confirmation, p. 165)**

The Question of the Week

Who around you could use your mercy this week?

Something to Do at Home

As a family, fill a bag with clothes or food for a food pantry or your parish's Lenten drive.

To Print: "The Good Samaritan (Luke 10:25-37)" (Confirmation, p. 152): 1 per child · "What Is Mercy?" (Confirmation, p. 151): 1 per child · "The 7 Corporal Works of Mercy" (Confirmation, p. 154): 1 per child · "The 7 Spiritual Works of Mercy" (Confirmation, p. 155): 1 per child · "The Corporal Works in Everyday Life" (Confirmation, p. 156): 1 per child

Week 20

MARCH

Lent: Serving Christ in Others

Goal: Help the young people understand that serving the least of our brothers and sisters is serving Jesus himself, and put it into action as a group.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Each person tells about a time when someone helped them when they needed it.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about Jesus in the least of his brothers (Matthew 25) and answer the questions. → **"Jesus in the Least of His Brothers (Matthew 25:31-46)" (Confirmation, p. 153)**
25 min	**Activity**	Choose and plan a concrete service project for the group. → **"My Team Service Project" (Confirmation, p. 164)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Our Father together for those who are suffering. → **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read about the life of Saint Teresa of Calcutta and answer the questions, then look back at the works of mercy you have practiced.

→ **"St. Teresa of Calcutta" (Confirmation, p. 190)**

→ **"The Works of Mercy I Have Practiced" (Confirmation, p. 166)**

The Question of the Week

How can you recognize Jesus in someone you meet?

Something to Do at Home

As a family, visit or call an elderly person or someone who lives alone.

To Print: "Jesus in the Least of His Brothers (Matthew 25:31-46)" (Confirmation, p. 153): 1 per child · "My Team Service Project" (Confirmation, p. 164): 1 for the group

Week 21

MID-MARCH

Palm Sunday and Holy Week

Palm Sunday: March 21, 2027

Goal: Help the young people follow Jesus during Holy Week and discover the sacred chrism, the oil of Confirmation, blessed by the bishop.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the page about the holy oils and the Chrism Mass, then answer the questions. → **"The Holy Oils and the Chrism Mass" (Confirmation, p. 90)**
10 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the new commandment Jesus gave on Holy Thursday. → **The New Commandment: "Love One Another" (Confirmation, p. 116)**
20 min	**Activity**	Do the crossword of the Triduum. → **"Holy Thursday, Good Friday, Holy Saturday" (150 Extra Activities, p. 70)**
15 min	**Prayer**	Pray the first seven Stations of the Cross together. → **"The Children's Stations of the Cross (1): Stations 1-7" (150 Extra Activities, p. 57)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

On Good Friday, pray the rest of the Stations of the Cross. Make the candle holder for the Easter Vigil.

→ **"The Children's Stations of the Cross (2): Stations 8-14" (150 Extra Activities, p. 58)**

→ **"The Easter Vigil: Light in the Night" (150 Extra Activities, p. 75)**

The Question of the Week

What does it mean for you to love others the way Jesus loved us?

Something to Do at Home

If you can, go together to your diocese's Chrism Mass or to a Holy Week service.

To Print: "The Holy Oils and the Chrism Mass" (Confirmation, p. 90): 1 per child · The New Commandment: "Love One Another" (Confirmation, p. 116): 1 per child · "Holy Thursday, Good Friday, Holy Saturday" (150 Extra Activities, p. 70): 1 per child · "The Children's Stations of the Cross (1): Stations 1-7" (150 Extra Activities, p. 57): 1 per child

Week 22

LATE MARCH

Easter: Christ Is Risen

Easter Sunday: March 28, 2027

Goal: Help the young people understand that Jesus is truly risen and that his victory over death is the heart of our faith.

In Class 1 hour

15 min	**Welcome**	Cut out the question eggs and hide them around the room: everyone looks for some and answers them. → **"The Easter Egg Hunt With Questions" (150 Extra Activities, p. 83)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the death and Resurrection of Jesus and answer the questions. → **"The Death and Resurrection of Jesus" (Confirmation, p. 60)**
20 min	**Activity**	Do the crossword of the appearances of the risen Jesus. → **"The Appearances of the Risen Jesus" (150 Extra Activities, p. 86)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Say the joyful Easter morning prayer together. → **"My Easter Morning Prayer" (150 Extra Activities, p. 84)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the story of Thomas again and do the true or false, then decorate the Paschal candle.

→ **"Thomas, the Apostle Who Wanted to See: True or False" (150 Extra Activities, p. 88)**

→ **"The Paschal Candle to Decorate" (150 Extra Activities, p. 89)**

The Question of the Week

What difference does the Resurrection of Jesus make for you today?

Something to Do at Home

During Easter Time, say "Alleluia!" together before Sunday dinner.

To Print: "The Easter Egg Hunt With Questions" (150 Extra Activities, p. 83): 1 for the group · "The Death and Resurrection of Jesus" (Confirmation, p. 60): 1 per child · "The Appearances of the Risen Jesus" (150 Extra Activities, p. 86): 1 per child · "My Easter Morning Prayer" (150 Extra Activities, p. 84): 1 per child

Week 23

APRIL

The First Christians

Goal: Help the young people discover how the Church was born and grew, from the Apostles until today.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Complete the timeline of the main dates in Church history. → **"Two Thousand Years of Church History" (Confirmation, p. 205)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the first Christians and answer the questions together. → **"The First Christians (Acts 2:42-47)" (Confirmation, p. 206)**
25 min	**Activity**	Split the group in two: one half takes the persecutions and the catacombs, the other takes Constantine. Each half presents its page, then everyone numbers the key dates in order. → **"The Persecutions and the Catacombs" (Confirmation, p. 207)** → **"Constantine and the Edict of Milan (313)" (Confirmation, p. 208)** → **"Key Dates in Church History" (Confirmation, p. 221)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Apostles' Creed together, the faith of the first Christians. → **"The Apostles' Creed" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 5)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the lives of Saint Peter and Saint Paul and answer the questions.
→ **"St. Peter" (Confirmation, p. 181)**
→ **"St. Paul" (Confirmation, p. 182)**

The Question of the Week

What surprises you most about the life of the first Christians?

Something to Do at Home

Visit one of the oldest churches near you and find out how long it has been there.

To Print: "Two Thousand Years of Church History" (Confirmation, p. 205): 1 per child · "The First Christians (Acts 2:42-47)" (Confirmation, p. 206): 1 per child · "The Persecutions and the Catacombs" (Confirmation, p. 207): 1 per child · "Constantine and the Edict of Milan (313)" (Confirmation, p. 208): 1 per child · "Key Dates in Church History" (Confirmation, p. 221): 1 per child

Week 24

MID-APRIL

The Beatitudes: Happiness According to Jesus

Goal: Help the young people discover the Beatitudes: the path to happiness that Jesus offers to those who follow him.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Think alone, then talk it over: what does it really mean to be happy? → **"Blessed, Really? Happiness According to Jesus" (Confirmation, p. 133)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the Sermon on the Mount and answer the questions together. → **"The Sermon on the Mount (Matthew 5:1-12)" (Confirmation, p. 121)**
25 min	**Activity**	Complete the Beatitudes, then match each one to its promise. Those who finish early can do the secret alphabet. → **"The Beatitudes" (Confirmation, p. 131)** → **"The Beatitudes and Their Promises" (Confirmation, p. 130)** → **"The Secret Alphabet of the Beatitudes" (Catechism Games, p. 34)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray the Our Father together. → **"The Our Father" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 2)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the page about peacemakers and the case study about the playground, then choose your favorite Beatitude.

→ **"Blessed are the peacemakers" (Confirmation, p. 128)**

→ **"Being a Peacemaker on the Playground" (Confirmation, p. 132)**

→ **"My Favorite Beatitude" (Confirmation, p. 134)**

The Question of the Week

Which Beatitude would you like to live this week, and how?

Something to Do at Home

If an argument breaks out at home, try to be peacemakers for one another.

To Print: "Blessed, Really? Happiness According to Jesus" (Confirmation, p. 133): 1 per child · "The Sermon on the Mount (Matthew 5:1-12)" (Confirmation, p. 121): 1 per child · "The Beatitudes" (Confirmation, p. 131): 1 per child · "The Beatitudes and Their Promises" (Confirmation, p. 130): 1 per child · "The Secret Alphabet of the Beatitudes" (Catechism Games, p. 34): 1 per child

Week 25

LATE APRIL

Who Is the Holy Spirit?

Goal: Help the young people discover that the Holy Spirit is a divine Person, present in the Bible from the very beginning, at Creation.

In Class 1 hour

5 min	**Welcome**	Ask everyone how they picture the Holy Spirit.
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the Holy Spirit and answer the questions together. → **"Who Is the Holy Spirit?" (Confirmation, p. 25)**
25 min	**Activity**	Discover the symbols of the Holy Spirit, then read the page that goes from Creation to the Baptism of Jesus. → **"The Symbols of the Holy Spirit: Dove, Fire, Wind, Water, Oil" (Confirmation, p. 26)** → **"The Holy Spirit, From Creation to the Baptism of Jesus" (Confirmation, p. 49)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Pray "Come, Holy Spirit" together. → **"Come, Holy Spirit" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 12)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the page about the third part of the Creed, then the page about Confirmation, the sacrament of the Spirit.

→ **"I Believe in the Holy Spirit" (Confirmation, p. 56)**

→ **"Confirmation, Sacrament of the Spirit" (Confirmation, p. 79)**

The Question of the Week

In what situation would you need the help of the Holy Spirit?

Something to Do at Home

Every morning this week, say a short prayer to the Holy Spirit together.

To Print: "Who Is the Holy Spirit?" (Confirmation, p. 25): 1 per child · "The Symbols of the Holy Spirit: Dove, Fire, Wind, Water, Oil" (Confirmation, p. 26): 1 per child · "The Holy Spirit, From Creation to the Baptism of Jesus" (Confirmation, p. 49): 1 per child

Week 26

EARLY MAY

The Ascension: Jesus Goes Up to Heaven

The Ascension: Thursday, May 6 or Sunday, May 9, 2027 (depending on your diocese)

Goal: Help the young people understand that Jesus goes up to the Father and promises to stay with us and to send the Holy Spirit.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Do the true or false about the forty days after Easter. → **"Forty Days After Easter: True or False?" (150 Extra Activities, p. 93)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the Ascension and the return of Christ and answer the questions. → **"The Ascension and the Return of Christ" (Confirmation, p. 61)**
20 min	**Activity**	Complete the timeline of the fifty days, from Easter to Pentecost. → **"From Easter to Pentecost: The Fifty Days" (Confirmation, p. 28)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Read Jesus' promise and reflect on it together. → **"I Am With You Always" (150 Extra Activities, p. 94)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Make the Ascension mobile, then do the true or false about the Holy Spirit in the Bible.

→ **"The Ascension Mobile" (150 Extra Activities, p. 91)**

→ **"The Holy Spirit in the Bible" (Confirmation, p. 48)**

The Question of the Week

How do you know that Jesus is with you, even though you can't see him?

Something to Do at Home

Go to Mass as a family for the Ascension, on Thursday or Sunday depending on your diocese.

To Print: "Forty Days After Easter: True or False?" (150 Extra Activities, p. 93): 1 per child · "The Ascension and the Return of Christ" (Confirmation, p. 61): 1 per child · "From Easter to Pentecost: The Fifty Days" (Confirmation, p. 28): 1 per child · "I Am With You Always" (150 Extra Activities, p. 94): 1 per child

Week 27

MID-MAY

Pentecost: The Spirit Is Given

Pentecost: Sunday, May 16, 2027

Goal: Help the young people understand that at Pentecost the Holy Spirit is given to the Apostles, as he will be given to them on the day of their Confirmation.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Read the beginning of the Pentecost story, then the whole passage in the Bible (Acts 2). → **"The Story of Pentecost (Acts 2:1-13)" (Confirmation, p. 27)**
15 min	**Discover**	Do the Pentecost crossword together, then read the page about Peter's sermon. → **"Pentecost" (Confirmation, p. 29)** → **"Peter's Sermon (Acts 2:14-41)" (Confirmation, p. 30)**
20 min	**Activity**	Hand out the roles and act out the short Pentecost skit. → **A Pentecost Skit: "The Wind and the Fire" (150 Extra Activities, p. 151)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Learn the prayer to the Holy Spirit, then each person writes their own prayer. → **"Come, Holy Spirit": I Pray to the Holy Spirit (Confirmation, p. 46)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Every morning this week, pray "Come, Holy Spirit!" Then think it over: is the Holy Spirit still at work today?

→ **"Come, Holy Spirit!" (150 Extra Activities, p. 101)**

→ **"Is the Holy Spirit Still at Work Today?" (Confirmation, p. 47)**

The Question of the Week

If the Holy Spirit gave you courage like the Apostles, what would you do?

Something to Do at Home

On Pentecost Sunday, go to Mass and pray for everyone being confirmed in your diocese.

To Print: "The Story of Pentecost (Acts 2:1-13)" (Confirmation, p. 27): 1 per child · "Pentecost" (Confirmation, p. 29): 1 per child · "Peter's Sermon (Acts 2:14-41)" (Confirmation, p. 30): 1 per child · A Pentecost Skit: "The Wind and the Fire" (150 Extra Activities, p. 151): 1 per role · "Come, Holy Spirit": I Pray to the Holy Spirit (Confirmation, p. 46): 1 per child

Week 28

MAY

The Seven Gifts and the Fruits of the Spirit

Goal: Help the young people discover the seven gifts the Holy Spirit gives at Confirmation and the fruits he helps grow in us.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Complete the wheel of the seven gifts of the Holy Spirit. → **"The Wheel of the 7 Gifts of the Holy Spirit" (Confirmation, p. 31)**
20 min	**Discover**	Three pairs each read the page about one gift, then present it to the others. → **"The Gift of Wisdom" (Confirmation, p. 32)** → **"The Gift of Fortitude" (Confirmation, p. 35)** → **"The Gift of Piety" (Confirmation, p. 37)**
20 min	**Activity**	Match each gift to a real-life situation, then complete the tree of the fruits of the Spirit. → **"Each Gift in a Real-Life Situation" (Confirmation, p. 39)** → **"The Tree of the Fruits of the Spirit" (Confirmation, p. 43)**
5 min	**Prayer**	Pray "Come, Holy Spirit" together. → **"Come, Holy Spirit" (Catholic Prayers for Children, p. 12)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Read the 12 fruits of the Spirit, choose the one you want to grow, and do the quiz on the seven gifts.

→ **"The 12 Fruits of the Holy Spirit" (Confirmation, p. 42)**
→ **"Which Fruit Do I Want to Grow?" (Confirmation, p. 44)**
→ **"The Big Quiz on the 7 Gifts" (Confirmation, p. 41)**

The Question of the Week

Which of the seven gifts do you ask the Holy Spirit for the most, and why?

Something to Do at Home

Every evening, each family member names a fruit of the Spirit they saw in someone that day.

To Print: "The Wheel of the 7 Gifts of the Holy Spirit" (Confirmation, p. 31): 1 per child · "The Gift of Wisdom" (Confirmation, p. 32): 1 per pair · "The Gift of Fortitude" (Confirmation, p. 35): 1 per pair · "The Gift of Piety" (Confirmation, p. 37): 1 per pair · "Each Gift in a Real-Life Situation" (Confirmation, p. 39): 1 per child · "The Tree of the Fruits of the Spirit" (Confirmation, p. 43): 1 per child

Week 29

LATE MAY

Getting Ready for Confirmation

Goal: Help the young people learn how the celebration unfolds and what the anointing means, so they can live their Confirmation fully.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Fill in the missing headings for the main moments of the celebration. → **"The Rite of Confirmation" (Confirmation, p. 7)**
15 min	**Discover**	Read the page about the laying on of hands and the anointing, then the page about the bishop's words. → **"The Essential Rite: The Laying on of Hands and the Anointing With Chrism" (Confirmation, p. 8)** → **"Be sealed with the Gift of the Holy Spirit" (Confirmation, p. 16)**
20 min	**Activity**	Match each sign of Confirmation to its meaning, then share what touches you. → **"The Signs of Confirmation and What They Mean" (Confirmation, p. 19)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Read together the baptismal promises the young people will renew at Confirmation. → **"The Baptismal Promises I Renew" (Confirmation, p. 17)**
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Your child writes their prayer to the Holy Spirit and looks back on what they remember.

→ **"My Prayer to the Holy Spirit" (Confirmation, p. 236)**

→ **"What I Remember About the Holy Spirit" (Confirmation, p. 50)**

The Question of the Week

How do you feel as your Confirmation gets closer?

Something to Do at Home

Get the outfit ready together and invite the family and the sponsor to the celebration.

To Print: "The Rite of Confirmation" (Confirmation, p. 7): 1 per child · "The Essential Rite: The Laying on of Hands and the Anointing With Chrism" (Confirmation, p. 8): 1 per child · "Be sealed with the Gift of the Holy Spirit" (Confirmation, p. 16): 1 per child · "The Signs of Confirmation and What They Mean" (Confirmation, p. 19): 1 per child · "The Baptismal Promises I Renew" (Confirmation, p. 17): 1 per child

Week 30

EARLY JUNE

Confirmed and Sent: Thank You!

Goal: Help the young people give thanks for the year and understand that Confirmation is not an end, but a call to go out and serve others.

In Class 1 hour

10 min	**Welcome**	Each person looks back on the journey of preparation they have made with the Holy Spirit. → **"I Look Back on My Road to Confirmation" (Confirmation, p. 237)**
15 min	**Discover**	Think alone, then talk it over: what does being confirmed change in my life? → **"Being Confirmed: What Does It Change in My Life?" (Confirmation, p. 22)**
20 min	**Activity**	Find out what each person could do in the parish, then write your resolutions for after Confirmation. → **"My Commitment in My Parish" (Confirmation, p. 23)** → **"My Resolutions for After Confirmation" (Confirmation, p. 235)**
10 min	**Prayer**	Each person thanks God for this year in their own words. End by blessing each young person.
5 min	**Closing**	Ask the question of the week and explain the at-home activity.

At Home or If You Have Little Time 20 min

Fill in the keepsake page on the day of Confirmation. Your child looks at their place in the Church and writes down their favorite Bible passage.

→ **"The Day of My Confirmation" (Confirmation, p. 24)**

→ **"My Place in the Church" (Confirmation, p. 224)**

→ **"My Favorite Passage From the Word of God" (Confirmation, p. 233)**

The Question of the Week

How do you want to serve in the Church after your Confirmation?

Something to Do at Home

Have a small celebration meal and thank everyone who walked with your child.

To Print: "I Look Back on My Road to Confirmation" (Confirmation, p. 237): 1 per child · "Being Confirmed: What Does It Change in My Life?" (Confirmation, p. 22): 1 per child · "My Commitment in My Parish" (Confirmation, p. 23): 1 per child · "My Resolutions for After Confirmation" (Confirmation, p. 235): 1 per child · "The Day of My Confirmation" (Confirmation, p. 24): 1 per child